

---

PRODUCTBEACON

# The State of Government and Law Enforcement Intelligence Markets 2026

**Yohay Etsion**

Managing Director, ProductBeacon

2026-09-12

**Disclosure:** *This is ProductBeacon's independent, impartial market research on the government and national-security intelligence-software market, based solely on publicly available material. No vendor sponsors, no paywalled data, no analyst-firm reuse. The author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte, which competes in fronts covered here; this report reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position, and is not investment, legal, tax, or accounting advice. Full independence and sourcing methodology: [Methodology](#) →.*

## Front 5 – Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT / WEBINT)

---

*An independent ProductBeacon market briefing on the government & national-security intelligence software market – lawful interception, OSINT/WEBINT, decision intelligence. Front 5 of six.*

**Disclosures.** The author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte, which competes in this front. This chapter is independent ProductBeacon research based **solely on publicly available material**; it reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position. **This report does not constitute investment, legal, tax, or accounting advice.** No claim here should be relied upon as the basis for any investment decision. As of June 2026, the author holds no position in any named public security – directly or via a cybersecurity-sector ETF – and is not compensated by any named vendor.

### Glossary.

- **OSINT (Open-Source Intelligence)** – intelligence produced from publicly accessible, openly-available sources (web, social, public records, breach corpora, geospatial, technical data), collected and exploited without privileged network access, a warrant, or field hardware.<sup>1</sup>
- **WEBINT (Web Intelligence)** – the web-resident subset of OSINT: data collected from the internet (surface, deep, and dark web) and processed toward an investigative objective; in vendor usage, often the umbrella term for an integrated web-collection-plus-exploitation platform.<sup>2</sup>
- **SOCMINT (Social Media Intelligence)** – a subset of OSINT restricted to social-platform data: the collection and analysis of posts, networks, and metadata (timestamps, geolocation) to reveal information about individuals, groups, or trends.<sup>3</sup>

## 5.1 The Playing Ground

---

Open-source intelligence is the discipline of gathering and exploiting information that is already in the open. The sources are the web, social platforms, public records, breach corpora, satellite imagery, and the technical exhaust of the internet itself. The work is turning that raw material into something an analyst can act on. One vendor glossary in this exact market defines OSINT as “the process of gathering, analyzing, and utilizing information from publicly accessible sources.” It enumerates those sources as “social media platforms, websites and blogs, public government data, satellite imagery, public databases, academic publications and gray literature, technical data (WHOIS, DNS, Certificate Transparency), news and media outlets, public forums and online communities, leaked data, geospatial data, publicly available corporate documents, [and the] dark web.”<sup>4</sup> The buyer is a national-intelligence or national-security agency, a law-enforcement investigations unit, a defense or military-intelligence cell, a corporate-security or threat-intelligence function, or a financial-crime and due-diligence team.

The defining property of this front — the line that keeps the chapter coherent — is the *source being open and web-resident*. Access is unprivileged: a vendor or its customer can reach the source without a court order, a carrier tap, or a deployed device. That single property separates OSINT from every other front in this report, and it is worth stating the boundary precisely, because “open-source intelligence” is the front most prone to category sprawl. The word “open” gets stretched to cover anything that touches the internet, and the result is double-counting.

**What this front IS.** Collection and exploitation of openly-available, web-resident, social, and dark-web data, where the access is unprivileged. The core product is the open-source *collection-and-exploitation engine*: the scrapers, the dark-web crawlers, the social harvesters, the multilingual entity extraction over web text. The collector is graded here, in Open-Source Intelligence.

**What this front is NOT.** Three boundaries matter.

First, it is *not* intercepted content. Three other fronts depend on *privileged* access to a communications channel: the mass network collection of the National Agencies front, the warrant-scoped lawful interception of the Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers front, and the field radio-frequency collection of the Tactical Intelligence front. OSINT touches only what is openly broadcast or published. The bright line is the *privilege of access, not the subject matter*. A vendor can detect a threat actor’s chatter on a public Telegram channel and stay firmly inside Open-Source Intelligence; intercepting that same actor’s private call requires the machinery of the intercept fronts. Same target, different front, because the access right differs.

Second, it is *not* the fusion layer that *ingests* OSINT. An OSINT *collector* belongs to Open-Source Intelligence; a *fusion platform that ingests OSINT* belongs to the Fusion / Decision Intelligence front, with an Open-Source Intelligence reference. The test that keeps these apart is whether the *collection* or the *analytics-over-supplied-data* is the primary product. A vendor whose primary value is the open-source collection engine is graded here. A vendor whose primary value is multi-source analytics on top of feeds the customer supplies — link analysis, case management, cross-source correlation — is graded in the fusion front and merely referenced here. This is the single most important grading discipline for this front. Every serious OSINT vendor also markets analytics, so the only question that resolves the ambiguity is which half of the product the buyer is actually paying for.

Third, it is *not* generic cyber threat-intelligence that is not open-source-derived. Malware telemetry, honeypot data, proprietary sensor networks, and vendor-internal sinkhole data are threat intelligence but not OSINT — they are *proprietary* collection. Where a vendor blends OSINT with proprietary feeds, only the open-source-derived portion is the Open-Source Intelligence capability; the rest is adjacent. The heavy overlap between “OSINT platform” and “cyber threat-intelligence platform” is exactly why this front’s vendor universe overflows. The front’s problem is not finding enough contenders to grade. It is cutting the field down to the ones whose open-source collection is genuinely the product.

### Three buyer misconceptions

**“OSINT is free — it’s all on Google.”** The public-source *raw material* is free; the differentiated product is everything that sits on top of it. Collection at scale, dark-web access, multilingual coverage, de-duplication and entity-resolution, and a provenance trail are what a buyer actually pays for. Babel Street, for example, markets searching “across thousands of sources... in over 200 languages with citations and data provenance.”<sup>5</sup> The citations and the provenance are the product, not the raw posts. There is a real free floor here: community-edition tools and open-source toolkits, and increasingly general-purpose

large language models running ad-hoc collection.<sup>b</sup> But that floor only compresses the *low end* of basic open-web collection. It pushes commercial vendors up-stack, toward the capabilities the free tools cannot match.

**“OSINT and SOCMINT are the same thing.”** Social-media intelligence is a *subset* of OSINT, restricted to social platforms. OSINT spans the entire open web, public records, technical data, breach corpora, and geospatial sources.<sup>2 3</sup> A vendor strong in social collection is not automatically strong in dark-web or breach-data collection; they are different disciplines with different access problems.

**“If it’s public, collecting it is legal.”** Public *visibility* does not equal *lawful collection*. Platform terms-of-service, anti-circumvention rules, and data-protection law all constrain *how* public data may be gathered – and the constraint has teeth, as the scraping litigation below shows.

## The data and collection stack

The front has two strata: a collection-and-source layer, and an exploitation-and-analytics layer that turns raw open data into structured intelligence. Almost all the differentiation lives in *which sources a vendor can reach* and *how well it exploits them*.

On the collection side, the source classes line up roughly by how hard they are to reach.

The **surface web** – indexed news, blogs, corporate sites, forums, public-records portals – is the cheapest and most contested layer. Everyone collects it, and this is where scraping legality bites. Technical data (WHOIS, DNS, Certificate Transparency) sits here too, as a distinct “technical OSINT” discipline.

The **deep web** – content behind forms, logins, paywalls, or simply not indexed – is reachable without special privilege, but it requires per-source connectors and query automation. Deep-web *breadth* – the number of gated-but-public databases a vendor has built connectors for – is a quiet moat that is hard to verify from outside. I’d hypothesize that vendors’ “thousands of sources” claims gesture at this connector inventory, though, as the collection-breadth axis below notes, the figure is not independently verifiable.

The **dark web** – Tor and I2P forums, ransomware leak sites, illicit marketplaces, closed channels – is a specialist discipline requiring persona management, access maintenance, and operational tradecraft. Vendors anchor here explicitly, with Cybersixgill describing automated collection “from dark web forums, marketplaces, and social media platforms,”<sup>7</sup> Flashpoint marketing intelligence across “Dark Web, Malware, Vulnerability, OSINT, Financial, Domain, Identity” classes,<sup>8</sup> and Fivecast publishing a dedicated dark-web collection methodology.<sup>9</sup>

The **social layer** (SOCMINT) – posts, networks, metadata, sentiment – is the most legally exposed modality, for reasons the scraping case below makes plain.

**Breach and leaked data** – credential dumps and leaked databases circulating in cybercrime channels – is a recognized OSINT source class<sup>4</sup> used for identity-resolution and exposure monitoring. It carries the heaviest data-protection and provenance risk of any source here.

**Multilingual content** – coverage of non-Latin scripts and low-resource languages – is a hard collection-and-exploitation problem that vendors market as a primary discriminator. Babel Street positions on processing “any publicly available input in hundreds of languages.”<sup>5</sup> For a national-security buyer whose

targets operate in Arabic, Farsi, Russian, Mandarin, and regional dialects, language coverage is not a feature line. It is a gating capability.

On the exploitation side, the analytics that stays *inside* an Open-Source Intelligence product — as distinct from a standalone fusion platform — runs to a handful of functions. They are collection orchestration and de-duplication, multilingual entity extraction and resolution, identity-graph construction across selectors, anomaly and network analysis over social data, and alerting on standing queries. The 2026 inflection adds large-language-model-assisted summarization and natural-language investigation. The grading test holds: this analytics stays inside Open-Source Intelligence when it operates over the vendor's own open-source collection, and tips into the fusion front only when it is sold standalone over customer-supplied feeds.

## The six axes buyers discriminate on

Six dimensions separate the serious vendors from the rest, and each maps to a real, publicly observable cost-and-capability structure.

1. **Language and translation coverage.** The breadth of languages a vendor can *collect, translate, and entity-resolve* — not merely keyword-match. The public proxy is the vendor's own stated language count tied to provenance (Babel Street's "over 200 languages"<sup>5</sup>). This is the hardest-to-fake axis: keyword translation is cheap, but cross-script entity-resolution at investigative grade is not. I read a vendor's willingness to publish a specific language count tied to provenance as a stronger signal than a generic "multilingual" claim.
2. **Dark and deep-web depth.** Reach into Tor and I2P forums, ransomware leak sites, and gated-but-public databases — plus the tradecraft to maintain access. The public proxy is a *published* collection methodology and explicit source-class enumeration<sup>8 9</sup> versus generic "we monitor the dark web" marketing. This is where the cyber-threat-intel cohort out-differentiates the social-first WEBINT cohort.
3. **Collection breadth.** The raw count and diversity of connected sources across surface, deep, social, dark, breach, and records. The public proxy is the "thousands of sources" claim — directionally informative but *not independently verifiable*, so they read as positioning claims, not facts, unless tied to a published source inventory.
4. **LLM-native versus bolt-on AI — as positioning, not verified architecture.** An outside party cannot verify a vendor's true internal architecture. So this axis must be read as *how a vendor markets itself*, with a falsifiable test on public proxies. The 2026 market is visibly bifurcating between vendors retrofitting generative AI onto an existing collection stack and vendors positioning AI as the native interface. Babel Street markets "agentic AI" explicitly: "Insights Investigator is agentic AI that gives analysts a single natural language interface to run threat investigations, monitor emerging risks, and surface connections" and "plans and executes multi-step workflows."<sup>10</sup> I read "agentic AI" and "natural language interface" as the current category-defining positioning move in this front — not yet a verified architectural moat. The test runs through the second half of 2026. If the agentic-OSINT entrants publish named government reference wins or independent (not vendor-asserted) time-to-insight benchmarks, the LLM-native claim graduates from positioning to a defensible differentiator. If they do not, it stays a watchlist item rather than a claim the analysis can lean on.

5. **Identity-graph and correlation depth.** How deeply a vendor resolves selectors — an email, a phone, a handle, an image — into unified entities, and maps relationships across sources. This is the difference between “here are forty hits for this handle” and “here is the resolved person, their aliases, their network, with provenance on each edge.” The public proxy is published case studies and the presence of cross-source correlation in product descriptions, versus single-source search.
6. **Data provenance and defensibility.** Whether collected intelligence carries an auditable chain — source, timestamp, citation — that survives legal and evidentiary scrutiny, and whether the *collection method itself* is defensible (terms-of-service-compliant, not fake-account scraping). The public proxy is explicit “citations and data provenance” positioning<sup>5</sup> and, inversely, litigation exposure. I read provenance and defensibility as having flipped from a compliance checkbox to a *competitive* axis. A buyer that adopts a vendor whose collection method is legally contestable inherits that vendor’s litigation risk. So defensible collection is now a sales differentiator, not just a hygiene item.

## The public barriers

Two structural barriers are most specific to this front, and one — scraping legality — has no analog anywhere else in this report.

**Export controls on surveillance technology.** Open-source tooling sold for surveillance use sits inside the dual-use export-control net. That net gates *who* a vendor may sell to across borders. The multilateral baseline is the 42-state Wassenaar Arrangement, which added commercial surveillance technologies to its dual-use control list beginning in 2013. The precise placement matters and is often mis-stated. In the implementing regimes, *intrusion-software* controls fall under **Category 4 (Computers)**, while *IP-network communications surveillance systems* fall under **Category 5 Part 1 (Telecommunications)** — not both under “Category 5,” as the shorthand sometimes has it.<sup>11</sup>

The U.S. implementation came via a Bureau of Industry and Security interim final rule published on 2021-10-21. It controls two categories. The first is software “specially designed... for the generation, command and control, or delivery of ‘intrusion software’” under ECCN 4D004. The second is “IP network communications surveillance systems or equipment” under ECCN 5A001.j. Both are controlled for national-security and anti-terrorism reasons, and a new License Exception ACE (Authorized Cybersecurity Exports) carves out certain destinations.<sup>12</sup>

The European Union’s Dual-Use Regulation 2021/821 adds an Article 5 catch-all on cyber-surveillance items. It requires an export authorization where the items “are or may be intended for use in connection with internal repression and/or the commission of serious violations of human rights.” Covered technologies named in the guidance include “telecommunications interception systems, internet surveillance systems, intrusion software and forensic tools.”<sup>13</sup> One honest qualifier: a public analysis from SIPRI finds that “use of the new catch-all control has been limited to date”<sup>13</sup> — the control exists on paper, but enforcement practice is still maturing.

Pure open-source collection over public data sits at the lighter-touch end of this net relative to intrusion and implant tooling. But the export-control frame supplies the front’s legitimacy boundary, and it is the natural place to seat the surveillance-vendor discussion. One discipline binds throughout. Any certification or clearance claim about a named vendor must cite the certifying body or the vendor’s own public statement, never an analyst assertion — a wrong certification claim on a named company is a credibility *and* a defamation hit.

**Platform terms-of-service and scraping legality.** This barrier has no analog in the intercept fronts, because this front collects from *third-party platforms whose terms bind the collector*. The clearest public case is *Meta v. Voyager Labs*. Meta sued Voyager in January 2023 in the Northern District of California, alleging that Voyager “created 38,000 Facebook accounts” and used them “to scrape data from more than 600,000 social media users,” including “posts, likes, friend lists, photos, and comments.”<sup>14</sup> In May 2024, U.S. District Judge Araceli Martinez-Olguin allowed the suit to proceed, rejecting Voyager’s motion to dismiss and finding that Meta’s allegations could support claims that Voyager violated Facebook’s and Instagram’s terms of service.<sup>15</sup> The case ultimately settled, with Voyager agreeing “to refrain from scraping Facebook and Instagram and to permanently delete any data collected from Meta.”<sup>16</sup>

Voyager is in this report’s never-graded set, so this is descriptive market structure only, not a pattern claim about the company. But the structure it reveals is real: a major platform pursued, and a court allowed to proceed, terms-based claims against an OSINT vendor for collecting *publicly visible* data through fake accounts, and the matter ended in a settlement that barred the collection. I read the case as the public market’s clearest signal that *collection method* – not just *what data is public* – is now a structural constraint on this front, and that platform enforcement is a live competitive variable. The test runs through the second half of 2026. If additional platform-versus-vendor enforcement actions surface in the public record as named filings or settlements, the “defensible collection” axis hardens into a table-stakes procurement question. If enforcement stays a one-off, it remains an elevated-risk axis rather than a gate.

Behind the single case sits a genuinely unsettled legal backdrop across jurisdictions – U.S. terms-breach theories, EU lawful-basis and purpose-limitation constraints on reusing personal data, platform anti-circumvention rules. The *absence* of a settled rule is itself the barrier: each vendor must make a defensibility bet, and that bet is now visible in both its positioning and its litigation exposure.

**Clearance and accreditation.** For U.S.-federal and allied national-security buyers, the software-side gates that recur across this report apply here too: facility and personnel security clearances, and cloud accreditation (FedRAMP authorization, DoD Impact Levels) for hosted delivery. I did not extract a verbatim accreditation-requirement line from a live OSINT-specific U.S. solicitation in this pass. So the specific magnitude and timeline of the gate is an inference from the regime’s general applicability rather than a quoted fact – a thin spot worth naming as one. The war-chest analysis later in this chapter is better placed to answer it, through the pattern of specialists acquiring cleared U.S. delivery organizations.

One freshness correction for the contenders that follow. As of a 2026-06-14 web check, Cobwebs Technologies operates under PenLink, both held by the private-equity firm Spire Capital, with PenLink’s July 2023 acquisition announcement recording undisclosed terms. **Estimate:** approximately USD 200M, as reported by CTech. PenLink is integrating Cobwebs’ web-intelligence capability into its digital-investigation platform for “law enforcement, public safety, and national security customers.”<sup>17</sup> Babel Street does *not* own PenLink or Cobwebs – those sit under Spire Capital, and Babel Street is a separate vendor.<sup>17</sup> Named-outlet and co-investor reporting identify Babel Street as Veritas-backed at the time of its January 2024 Vertical Knowledge acquisition. The live Veritas portfolio page does not list Babel Street as of 2026-08-22, so current ownership is left unresolved and no reason is inferred from the non-listing.<sup>49</sup>

## 5.2 The Terrain

### Market size: three estimates, side by side, never averaged

There is no single number for the size of the OSINT market, and the honest way to present the sizing is to put the public estimates next to each other and let the spread speak. Three named research publishers size the broad OSINT market, and their definitions diverge widely enough that the disagreement is the finding, not a measurement error to be smoothed away.

| Publisher                                  | Definition used                                                                                                                                                                                               | Figure (as stated)                                                         | CAGR / period         |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Mordor Intelligence</b>                 | software platforms, data feeds, and managed services that gather, enrich, and analyze information in publicly available domains (excludes classified intel, standalone threat-hunting, hardware-only sensors) | USD 18.20B (2025)<br>→ USD 21.06B (2026) → USD 43.49B (2031) <sup>18</sup> | 15.62%<br>(2026–2031) |
| <b>The Business Research Company</b>       | OSINT revenues from “human intelligence and dark web analysis”; factory-gate values                                                                                                                           | USD 18.07B (2025)<br>→ USD 22.95B (2026) → USD 60.02B (2030) <sup>19</sup> | 27.2% (to 2030)       |
| <b>GlobalData / Global Market Insights</b> | OSINT “gathered from publicly available sources” across government and commercial sectors                                                                                                                     | USD 12.7B (2025) → USD 15.9B (2026) → USD 133.6B (2035) <sup>20</sup>      | 26.7%<br>(2026–2035)  |

The three publishers bracket the 2025 OSINT market at roughly USD 12.7B–18.2B, and the 2026 market at roughly USD 15.9B–22.95B. The growth rates split into two camps: Mordor’s mid-teens against the two high-twenties figures. I read this as a genuinely unsettled category boundary rather than a counting error. Mordor’s definition explicitly *excludes* standalone threat-hunting and hardware sensors. That is why its base and growth rate sit below the wider-scoped figures that fold dark-web analysis and broader cyber-intelligence into “OSINT.” If a fourth named publisher with a disclosed methodology lands inside USD 13–19B for 2025, the bracket holds; a figure outside it would mean the definitional drift is wider than I have assumed.

It is worth marking the overlap boundary with an adjacent, separately-tracked market. Mordor sizes the broader *threat intelligence* market at USD 9.21B (2025) rising to USD 18.85B (2031) at a 12.7% CAGR, with the strategic-intelligence segment at a 33.60% revenue share.<sup>21</sup> Grand View Research separately projects the threat-intelligence platforms market to USD 36.53B by 2030.<sup>22</sup> I include these only to fix the seam. Cyber-threat-intel and OSINT share vendors – Recorded Future, Flashpoint, Cybersixgill all appear in both – but are tracked as distinct markets, and double-counting across the two is the principal sizing hazard in this front.

### The government slice: a labeled proxy, not a segment size

No clean public dollar figure isolates the government and national-security OSINT software slice. Given the opacity of government intelligence budgets, that is an expected, honest result, not a gap to be filled by invention. What *is* publicly stated is the government *share* of the OSINT market by named publishers,

which I carry strictly as a proxy — a share-of-market, not a standalone segment size. Mordor puts government intelligence agencies at 38.40% of 2025 OSINT revenue, the single largest end-user segment, with military and defense as a further distinct category.<sup>18</sup> Global Market Insights puts national security at 32% of 2025 market value, the dominant application segment, covering “counterterrorism, counter-intelligence, strategic warning and foreign capability assessment.”<sup>20</sup>

Applying those published shares to the publishers’ own market totals is bracketing arithmetic, and I label it as exactly that, not as a publisher figure. Mordor’s 38.40% government share of its USD 18.20B total implies an order-of-magnitude proxy near USD 7B for the government-intelligence OSINT slice in 2025. GMI’s 32% national-security share of its USD 12.7B total implies near USD 4B. The proxy range — roughly USD 4–7B for 2025 — is arithmetic on published *application-share* splits, not a methodology-disclosed segment sizing, and no publisher sells the latter. The harder currency for this front is not any market-derivative at all; it is the named, dated procurement evidence below.

## Demand drivers

Three forcing functions carry the analytical weight that the market numbers cannot.

**The open-data exhaust has outrun manual analysis.** The publishers converge on a single root driver: the volume of openly-available data has grown faster than any analyst team can read it. Global Market Insights frames demand around the “rapid increase in publicly available online data” across “blogs, social media sites, news sites, web forums, internet of things (IoT) devices.”<sup>20</sup> Multilingual scale is a named buyer requirement rather than a feature. Babel Street states publicly that it analyzes content across “over 200 languages,” finding connections in multilingual data “from social media, the deep web, and public records.”<sup>23</sup> (Dataminr’s own filing-grade description cites “trillions of daily computations across billions of public data inputs from over 100,000 unique public data sources.” It spans “global and regional social media platforms, blogs, web forums... the deep and dark web, cyber signals, and public IoT sensors” — a vivid statement of the source span. But it dates to a 2021-03-23 press release, so I carry it as a description of breadth, not as a current metric.<sup>24</sup>) Dark and deep-web depth is a distinct vector the publishers single out, with The Business Research Company defining part of its OSINT market as “dark web analysis” revenue.<sup>19</sup> Every expansion of the open-data exhaust — more platforms, more languages, more dark-web venues — widens the gap between what is publicly knowable and what a human can manually process. That gap is precisely what commercial platforms monetize.

**Government buyers are institutionalizing OSINT as a named discipline.** The U.S. intelligence community has publicly committed to OSINT as a standing mission rather than an ad-hoc capability. The CIA has publicly released an OSINT strategy that calls for building data-science and AI talent and explicitly enlists large language models in its OSINT mission.<sup>25</sup> The buyer set the publishers name is broad and government-weighted — government intelligence agencies, military and defense, federal, state, and local law enforcement, plus financial-services and corporate-security threat-intel teams.<sup>18 20</sup> Recorded Future’s own public client claim — “more than 1,900 clients across 75 countries, including the governments of 45 countries” — is a public datapoint on the government density of the buyer base.<sup>26</sup>

**A commercial base sits below the government buyers.** The same publishers that put government at 32–38% of revenue also show financial services, cybersecurity providers, and corporate-risk firms as material end-user segments.<sup>18 20</sup> I read this as the structurally important feature of this front relative to the classified-collection fronts. OSINT has a large *commercial* recurring-revenue base — the part that needs no warrant and no clearance — which several specialists use as the platform from which they

attack government tenders. If the named OSINT specialists' public disclosures show government revenue growing materially faster than commercial through 2027, the "commercial base funds the government push" read weakens.

## The AI and LLM shift

The clearest 2025–2026 public signal in this front is that the incumbents are re-positioning around generative and agentic AI to compress the analyst workflow. The discipline here is the same one the differentiation axis above demands: this is framed strictly as what vendors *publicly claim*, because true architecture cannot be verified from outside — "positions itself as," not "is."

The capital is explicitly chasing it. Dataminr raised USD 100M from Fortress Investment Group in April 2025 "to accelerate its development of generative and agentic AI products," following USD 85M (March 2025) from NightDragon and HSBC.<sup>27</sup> A separate USD 300M financing led by Fortress and NightDragon was completed in September 2025, disclosed in Dataminr's 21 October 2025 ThreatConnect announcement, which states neither the instrument nor a valuation; it is a distinct event from the April convertible and the two are not summed here.<sup>40</sup> I flag the "\$4.1B valuation" figure that circulates with Dataminr as the 2021 Series F mark, not a current valuation;<sup>24</sup> the April-2025 raise was a convertible, the September-2025 financing's instrument is not stated in the announcing release, and neither is disclosed as a fresh primary equity mark.<sup>27 40</sup> Babel Street publicly markets "agentic AI for accelerated insights into global security," with "multilingual data summarization, pattern identification, and social connection analysis" as its AI workflow claim.<sup>28</sup> Palantir positions its AIP — using "generative and agentic AI models, including large language models (LLMs)" inside Gotham and Foundry, deployed to government from 2023 — as the operationalization layer over intelligence data.<sup>29</sup> Palantir's relevance to *this* front, though, is as the fusion layer that *ingests* OSINT, not as a pure collector. And Fivecast, the Australian specialist, raised an AUD 30M Series A for an "AI and machine-learning-powered" platform scanning "social media and the dark web."<sup>30</sup>

The shared public claim across these vendors is that large-language-model and agentic AI compress the time from raw public-data ingestion to analyst-ready insight. The observable proxies are funding explicitly earmarked for generative or agentic AI (Dataminr's April-2025 round states this purpose verbatim), public product-page repositioning toward "agentic," and named government reference wins. If the AI-native entrants cannot be named from public pages with a public capability claim, this trend demotes from a central convergence pillar to a watchlist item. For now, several of them *can* be named, which is what keeps it a live candidate.

## Regulatory and procurement structure

**How U.S. federal OSINT is bought.** Government OSINT in the United States is bought predominantly through commercial-off-the-shelf software subscriptions on established federal vehicles, not through bespoke sovereign systems. That is the accessible-procurement pattern, and a sharp contrast to the classified-collection fronts. The GSA Schedule, via reseller Carahsoft, is the dominant vehicle: Babel Street's "AI-powered solutions," OSINT included, were added to "Carahsoft's GSA Schedule contract," making them available to "Federal, State and Local Government agencies."<sup>31</sup> The named, dated award evidence on the public record makes the contestability concrete:

| Buyer                                                     | Vendor       | Value                                           | What it bought                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FBI                                                       | Babel Street | up to USD 27M (2022)                            | 5,000 software licenses <sup>32</sup>                                                                                                                                  |
| DoD (PADELS)                                              | Dataminr     | USD 24,923,076.93                               | enterprise OSINT alerting subscription, 36-week + 15-week option <sup>33</sup>                                                                                         |
| "U.S. Department of War" (First Alert enterprise program) | Dataminr     | USD 318M (five-year award announced 2026-08-26) | enterprise real-time alerting from publicly available information, through 2031; the department is named here exactly as Dataminr's own release names it <sup>41</sup> |

I read the Babel Street-versus-Dataminr GAO bid protest over the DoD PADELS award<sup>33</sup> as the cleanest public signal that this is a *recompeted, contestable* procurement lane. Vendors litigate the awards on the public record – in contrast to the incumbent-locked sovereign systems elsewhere in this report.

**The In-Q-Tel signal.** In-Q-Tel, the intelligence community's non-profit strategic investor, "funded primarily by the Central Intelligence Agency," is the public signal of which commercial data and AI capabilities the community is steering toward. It has invested in roughly 490 companies over 25 years, with 37 investments in 2025.<sup>34</sup> I carry it as a *directional* procurement-intent signal – where IC capital flows is where IC demand is forming – not as an OSINT-specific dollar figure. Its portfolio spans data and AI infrastructure broadly, and pinning a specific OSINT thesis on it from public sources would over-claim.

**Consolidation as a market-structure force.** The 2024–2025 deal flow shows OSINT and intelligence assets being absorbed into larger platforms. Mastercard acquired Recorded Future for USD 2.65B from Insight Partners (announced September 2024), framing it as "the world's largest threat intelligence company."<sup>26 35</sup> Cobwebs Technologies, the Israeli WEBINT vendor, joined PenLink after PenLink announced the acquisition through Spire Capital. Spire Capital owns both companies. **Estimate:** approximately USD 200M as reported by CTech; transaction terms were undisclosed. This is the deal that defines the current PenLink/Cobwebs entity referenced in this report.<sup>36</sup> That single-entity status is confirmed. Named-outlet and co-investor reporting identify Babel Street as Veritas-backed at the time of the January 2024 Vertical Knowledge acquisition; current ownership remains unresolved.<sup>49</sup>

**The scraping and privacy vector – asymmetric, and the front's defining medium-term risk.** OSINT's raw material is openly-available data, which puts it squarely inside the 2024–2026 tightening of data-broker and scraping law. That is a real force, but an *asymmetric* one, because national-security and law-enforcement use is frequently carved out.

On the commercial edge, scraping of public personal data is under sustained legal pressure. Clearview AI's facial-image scraping drew more than EUR 91M in fines across 15 jurisdictions by 2025, including a EUR 20M Italian order and a EUR 30.5M Dutch order. It also drew a roughly USD 51M class-action settlement that received final approval on 2025-03-20. The regulatory backdrop is one in which EU authorities have held that "public availability is not a sufficient lawful basis under GDPR."<sup>37</sup> U.S. enforcement tightened and then partly reversed, with a carve-out running through both moves. The FTC finalized orders in January 2025 against Mobilewalla, Gravy Analytics, and X-Mode/Outlogic barring the sale of sensitive location data – orders that *exempt* national-security and law-enforcement purposes.<sup>38</sup> Meanwhile the CFPB's broader data-broker rule, which would have classed some brokers as FCRA consumer-reporting agencies, was withdrawn on 2025-05-15.<sup>39</sup>

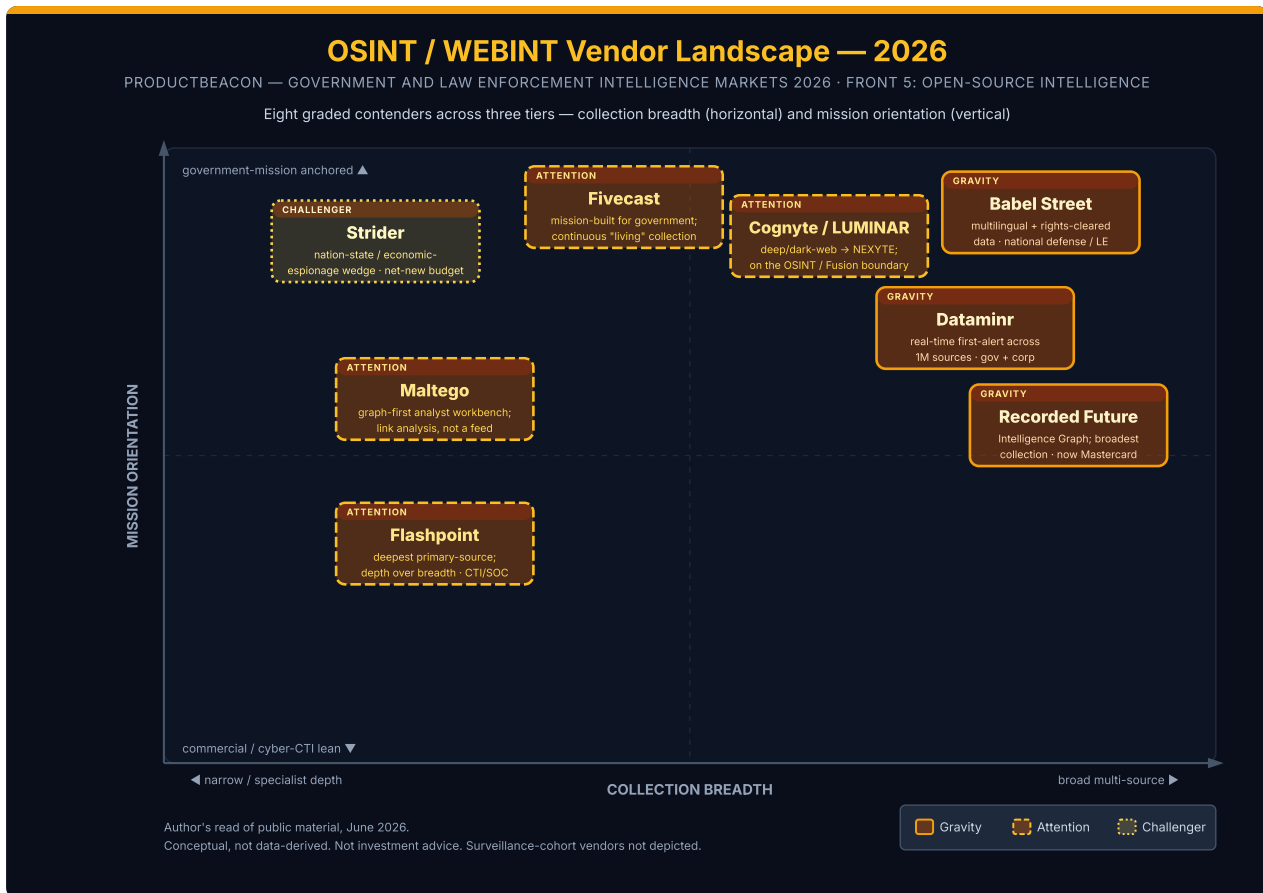
I read the net regulatory vector as ambiguous-but-tightening on the commercial edge and carved-out on the government edge. Consumer-facing data-broker selling is constrained, while law-enforcement and national-security access is repeatedly exempted, and the most sweeping U.S. broker rule was withdrawn. If a major OSINT or WEBINT vendor loses a government contract or faces a regulator order *specifically tied* to public-data scraping during 2026–2027, the “government edge is carved out” read weakens. The carve-outs are publicly contested. Citizen Lab’s analysis of PenLink’s ad-based geolocation and Amnesty International’s reporting on Palantir and Babel Street surveillance concerns are the named-outlet evidence of that<sup>38</sup>, and I surface those only as descriptive public market-force commentary, not as a pattern claim. This legal vector is, to my read, the most likely source of a 2026–2027 discontinuity in this front.

---

## 5.3 The Contenders

---

Open-source intelligence is the front where the candidate list overflows the cap rather than struggling to fill it. The structural map surfaces sixteen-plus public OSINT/WEBINT vendors with quotable self-positioning, so the discipline here is *cutting*. The job is to choose the eight that define the front’s center of gravity, shape its 2026 demand, and carry the architecture-disruption story — not to backfill thin rows. Eight vendors are graded across three tiers: 3 Gravity (the structural anchors a buyer cannot map the front without naming), 4 Attention (the vendors shaping demand, M&A, and the AI-native narrative), and 1 Challenger (the funded specialist whose trajectory is the interesting bet). The remaining candidates are placed deliberately — as cross-references, as Plays, or cut — and the cut line is documented at the end of this section so the selection can be defended.



Author's read of public material, June 2026. Vendor positions are conceptual, not data-derived. Tier color-coding: Gravity (burnt orange), Attention (amber), Challenger (pale amber). Not investment advice.

## Gravity tier

### Recorded Future

*"Threat Intelligence cuts through the noise with a clear and comprehensive view of the threats that matter to your organization."* — Recorded Future, Threat Intelligence product page, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>42</sup>

Recorded Future is the category's structural anchor, publicly described as "the world's largest threat intelligence company, with more than 1,900 clients across 75 countries, including the governments of 45 countries and over 50% of the Fortune 100."<sup>43</sup> Its stated USP is breadth of collection: indexing surface web, dark web, and technical feeds into a single Intelligence Graph that produces risk scores, with customers citing "the huge amount of sources from which they are gathering intelligence."<sup>42</sup> Target buyer is the threat-intelligence team, threat analyst, and SOC team across enterprise and government. Pricing signal: named-outlet aggregation puts entry pricing for small organizations at "\$50,000–\$100,000 annually,"<sup>44</sup> a rare public anchor in a front where most pricing is dark. Architecturally — and this is positioning, not a verified internal read — it presents as a graph-native data platform with bolt-on

generative-AI assistance, marketing AI as an analyst accelerant layered on the Intelligence Graph rather than an LLM-native core. Sourcing here is rich: vendor-controlled self-positioning plus heavy named-outlet coverage.

The single most consequential ownership fact in the front sits here: **Mastercard acquired Recorded Future for \$2.65B**, announced 12 September 2024 and closed 20 December 2024. The category's largest pure-play is now a payments-giant subsidiary inside Mastercard's cyber and identity portfolio.<sup>45</sup> I read this as the central tension of the Gravity tier. The structural anchor is no longer independent, which is both a distribution windfall (Mastercard's reach) and an open question about how a government-sector franchise fares inside a commercial payments parent.

## Dataminr

*"AI-Powered Real-Time Event, Threat & Risk Intelligence ... Dataminr's AI platform delivers the earliest warnings on high impact events."* — Dataminr homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>46</sup>

Dataminr is the speed archetype of the front. It positions as "The Leading AI Platform for Real-Time Event, Threat & Risk Intelligence,"<sup>46</sup> and its defining claim is *earliest signal*, first-alert latency rather than depth of after-the-fact analysis. The stated differentiation is real-time scale across "1M public data sources," built on "50+ proprietary LLMs." That stack adds multi-modal fusion, generative, and agentic AI.<sup>46</sup> Target buyer spans corporate security, the public sector ("100+ U.S. government agencies, 20+ international governments"), and newsrooms ("1,500+ newsrooms").<sup>46</sup> On architecture, Dataminr markets itself among the most AI-native vendors in the front. The multi-modal-fusion / generative / agentic stack is presented as the product's core, not a bolt-on, and in March 2026 it launched "Dataminr for Cyber Defense," a suite "built with agentic and predictive AI at its core."<sup>47</sup> That this is positioning rather than externally verifiable architecture is the standing caveat across the whole front. Ownership: private; the 2026 story is the cyber-defense expansion, which I read as Dataminr extending from real-time alerting toward the fusion/analytics layer — a move up the stack toward where Recorded Future and the Fusion / Decision Intelligence platforms already sit.

## Babel Street

*"Babel Street Data Dominance™ helps you turn chaotic and multilingual digital exhaust into verified, contextual intelligence — at scale."* — Babel Street homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>48</sup>

Babel Street is the multilingual-and-licensed-data anchor of the Gravity tier. Its 2026 framing leads with "Agentic Risk Intelligence" and "Governed AI agents on rights-cleared, mission-grade data to produce decision-ready intelligence in minutes, not days," under the buyer line "Trusted by those who can't afford to be wrong."<sup>48</sup> The stated USP pairs multilingual breadth (a "200+ languages" lineage) with a "rights-cleared, mission-grade data" governance pitch — positioning data-licensing and provenance as the differentiator against scrape-only rivals. Target buyer is national defense, law enforcement, global enterprise, and FinTech. Architecturally it markets a 2026 repositioning toward "governed AI agents" over a proprietary licensed-data foundation (positioning, not verified). Ownership and freshness: private.

Named-outlet and co-investor reporting identify Babel Street as Veritas-backed at the time of the January 2024 Vertical Knowledge acquisition. The live Veritas portfolio page does not list Babel Street as of 2026-08-22, so current ownership remains unresolved and no reason is inferred from the non-listing.<sup>49</sup>

The 2025–26 surface is an aggressive build-and-hire cycle. **John Larson (ex-Booz Allen) appointed President and Chief AI Officer in December 2025**, alongside Maura Burns, former CIA COO, joining the Board of Advisors in November 2025 and a new CRO — a leadership stack I read as signalling a deeper federal-and-AI push.<sup>50</sup> (The IP M&A that built the analytics base spans the Dunami link-analysis IP assets that Babel Street announced it had acquired on 8 June 2020, Rosette announced 28 November 2022 and recorded closed 31 December 2022, and Vertical Knowledge announced and recorded closed 22 January 2024. That is a sustained multi-year build-and-buy programme, not a single 2020 event, and is named here to place the lineage rather than as 2026 momentum.<sup>51</sup>)

## Attention tier

### Flashpoint

*"The Best Data for The Best Intelligence ... Stay ahead with intelligence sourced from where threats begin, guided by experts and AI."* — Flashpoint homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>52</sup>

Flashpoint is the primary-source-depth contender — its third pillar is "Industry's Deepest Primary Source Intelligence ... Access data from real adversary spaces that others can't reach."<sup>52</sup> Where Recorded Future and Dataminr lead on open-web breadth, Flashpoint leads on direct access to closed adversary spaces (illicit forums, marketplaces), with human-analyst enrichment as an explicit pillar ("Enriched by Expert Analyst Insight").<sup>52</sup> Target buyer spans CTI/SOC, fraud, corporate and physical security, vulnerability management, national security, and insider-threat teams, with named clients including the US DoD and Microsoft.<sup>52</sup> On architecture it positions human-plus-AI. In 2025 it added "AI Summarization ... for Search and Investigations within Flashpoint Ignite,"<sup>53</sup> framing AI as an analyst force-multiplier over a primary-source data lake (the Echosec acquisition supplied its social/OSINT collection layer). Ownership: private; the 2026 surface is the Ignite platform plus AI summarization and the annual Global Threat Intelligence Report as a demand-gen anchor.<sup>54</sup> My read: Flashpoint's wedge is depth-over-breadth, and the durable question is whether primary-source access stays defensible as the generalists' AI layers get better at synthesizing the open web.

### Cognyte (LUMINAR / external threat intelligence)

*Disclosure: the author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte. This is independent ProductBeacon research based solely on publicly available material; it reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position, and is not investment advice.*

*"Cognyte is a global leader in investigative analytics software that empowers a variety of government and other organizations with Actionable Intelligence for a Safer World™."* — Cognyte corporate homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>55</sup>

Cognyte is graded in this front strictly on its publicly-marketed external/web intelligence product, LUMINAR, plus its corporate positioning — sourced entirely to dated public pages, with no internal knowledge. LUMINAR is positioned as an “AI-powered external threat intelligence solution that empowers security and risk management leaders with comprehensive visibility into their threat landscape,” spanning “brand protection, fraud monitoring, executive protection and deep/dark web monitoring.”<sup>56</sup> The publicly-readable USP is the web and deep/dark-web collection layer, marketed alongside the NEXYTE decision-intelligence platform — breadth-of-source into a single investigative workspace rather than a standalone OSINT-collector pitch. (Cognyte’s public pages present LUMINAR and NEXYTE as a pairing; I do not assert a verified data pipeline between them from public material.) Target buyer, per the public pages, is “national SOCs, as well as the critical infrastructure, telecom, financial services, transportation and healthcare sectors,”<sup>56</sup> within a government, law enforcement, and national-security base of “hundreds of customers in approximately 100 countries.”<sup>55</sup>

Architecturally, NEXYTE markets “domain-specific, pre-trained AI models,” “co-pilots,” and “agentic decision flows.”<sup>57</sup> That is a positioning move toward AI-native decision intelligence. Whether the underlying architecture is LLM-native or bolt-on cannot be verified from outside, so this is read as positioning only. A scope note matters here. Cognyte’s broader WEBINT family beyond LUMINAR is **not** forced into a grade here, because no clean public quotable pillar for it exists; its portfolio breadth across the five fronts is carried by the Convergence chapter rather than manufactured into a grade in this section. My read: the public LUMINAR + NEXYTE framing places Cognyte squarely on the boundary between Open-Source Intelligence and Fusion, where LUMINAR is an external-collection product marketed next to a decision-intelligence platform, which is exactly the collector-or-fusion ambiguity this front turns on.

## Maltego

*“OSINT & Cyber Investigations Platform for High-Stakes Cases ... From data to intelligence - in minutes.”* — Maltego homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>58</sup>

Maltego is the analyst-workbench archetype — graded not as a data feed but as the link-analysis surface other data providers plug into. It positions “the all-in-one investigation platform that accelerates complex cyber investigations from hours to minutes.”<sup>58</sup> Its stated USP is graph-first link analysis: “the most widely used graph analysis platform for OSINT in the world,”<sup>59</sup> drawing “relationships between people, domains, infrastructure, social networks and leaks from open sources and commercial APIs, all on a single interactive graph.”<sup>59</sup> The connector/transform ecosystem is the moat — Maltego is the *de facto* standard analyst workbench that third-party data providers (including Social Links) integrate into. Target buyer, per its own page, is “Government organizations (2K+)” and “Private companies (4K+)” across law enforcement, defense and national security, CTI, banking, and insurance.<sup>58</sup> Architecture: graph-native, connector-driven, usage-based, adding “AI-powered sentiment analysis”<sup>58</sup> as a bolt-on rather than an LLM-native rebuild. Ownership: Maltego Technologies GmbH (Munich); the 2026 positioning is incremental AI features on the graph workbench. The reason it earns a grade is architectural distinctness — it is the investigator-workbench / link-analysis archetype sitting at the boundary between Open-Source Intelligence and Fusion, structurally different from the data-feed archetype of the Gravity three.

## Fivecast

*"Fivecast delivers an open-source intelligence platform that cuts through complex digital noise to surface the signals that matter."* — Fivecast homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>60</sup>

Fivecast is the clearest *mission-built-for-government* OSINT collector in the cut. Its pillars run under the brand line "ENGINEERED FOR INTELLIGENCE"<sup>60</sup>: "transforms digital noise into clarity, data into insight, and insight into decisive action" and "AI-powered technology that enables intelligence teams to uncover critical insights from masses of online data - before risk becomes reality." They frame a platform "born from collaboration between governments and research institutions," with "deep, targeted, and continuous data collection in near-real time."<sup>60</sup> That is its stated USP. It is purpose-built for the national-security, defense, and law-enforcement mission, distinct from the cyber-CTI lean of Recorded Future and Flashpoint. Target buyer, per its page, is "Government agencies (40+)," "Law enforcement (30+ police departments)," plus national security, defense intelligence, financial crime, and border security.<sup>60</sup> Architecturally it markets AI-powered collection-and-analysis as the core and positions on continuous "living intelligence" collection. Ownership: private, Australia-headquartered with a global footprint. The 2026 momentum is partnership-led — the Tranquility AI partnership announced in March 2026 (covered in the Plays section) — alongside a heavy government-event presence at the OSINT Tech Expo and SOF Week 2026.<sup>6162</sup> My read: Fivecast is the test case for whether a government-mission specialist can reach a full collect-to-evidence workflow through partnership stacks rather than M&A.

## Challenger tier

### Strider Technologies

*"The Frontier of Strategic Intelligence ... One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence."* — Strider Technologies homepage, accessed 2026-06-14<sup>63</sup>

Strider is the Challenger because it reframes what OSINT is *for*. The rest of the front serves cyber-threat and LEA-investigation centers; Strider instead markets a vertical the generalists don't own — *nation-state and economic-espionage risk* derived from public data. Its pillars promise to "make faster, more confident decisions with unparalleled insights into state-sponsored threats" and to "continuously discover, connect, and analyze global data to illuminate nation-state risk."<sup>63</sup> Its stated USP is a "Zero-touch architecture requiring no internal client data" with a claimed reach across "90K+ Hard-to-access sources,"<sup>63</sup> repositioning OSINT toward strategic counterintelligence — supply-chain, talent, IP, and PRC/Russia/Iran linkage. Target buyer, per its page, is "Fortune 100 companies and world leaders," critical infrastructure, financial services, high-tech/AI, academia, and government.<sup>63</sup> Architecturally it markets an "agentic intelligence" platform and positions as AI-native, though, as with every contender in this front, true architecture is unverifiable from outside. Ownership and freshness: private; it **raised a \$55M Series C led by Pelion in September 2024, reaching roughly \$117M total.**<sup>64</sup> Consistent with the Challenger discipline, the read stays descriptive and hedged. The interesting bet is whether "strategic

intelligence" hardens into a category that pulls net-new budget away from the cyber-CTI incumbents, or stays a well-funded vertical — a question the wedge Play in the next section tracks against public proxies rather than asserts.

### The cut line — why nine more public candidates are not graded here

The front's overflow forces a defensible cut. Each vendor below is real and publicly sourced; the cap simply requires a choice, and each is placed where it fits best — closer to a neighbouring front, duplicative of a graded archetype, or better carried as a Play.

- **Cybersixgill** — a strong dark-web CTI specialist (its public material cites collection of "7 million intelligence items from over 1,000 underground forums ... daily"<sup>65</sup>). Cut because its positioning overlaps Flashpoint's primary-source-depth pillar without a distinct wedge in this front, and carried as a Flashpoint cross-reference and War Chest color.
- **ZeroFox** — external cybersecurity / digital-risk protection. Cut because it skews DRP/brand-protection (nearer a cyber-security front than government OSINT) and its 2026 story is an ownership event, not a positioning one (**taken private by Haveli for \$350M in May 2024**<sup>66</sup>), making it a War Chests / consolidation data point.
- **PenLink (Tangles / WebLoc, ex-Cobwebs)** — a major LEA web-intelligence and location product. Cut from the graded set because its center of gravity is law-enforcement investigative tooling at the boundary between Open-Source Intelligence and the Monitoring Centers, and it is litigation-sensitive on location-data sourcing — carried as a consolidation Play and a Monitoring-Centers-adjacent cross-reference.
- **Primer** — defense/IC NLP-on-OSINT; cut because it positions as an AI analysis layer over unstructured data (adjacent to Fusion / Decision Intelligence) more than as an OSINT collector — placed as Convergence AI-native color and a Fusion / Decision Intelligence reference.
- **Social Links** — markets "industry-leading OSINT solutions" with "law enforcement agencies from 80+ countries."<sup>67</sup> Cut because much of its reach is *as a data provider inside Maltego* — the graded Maltego entry absorbs the archetype, and Social Links is named as ecosystem color.
- **ShadowDragon** — an LEA / financial-crime OSINT toolset; cut because it duplicates the Maltego / Social Links investigator-tooling archetype at smaller scale — named-reference only.
- **Skopenow** — an end-to-end OSINT platform with a sanctions / restricted-parties workflow lean; cut as sub-scale against the graded eight and overlapping the investigator-platform archetype — named as reference and as Play color on the compliance-OSINT trend.
- **HENSOLDT Analytics (formerly SAIL LABS Technology)** — a real OSINT business inside a diversified defense-sensor parent. HENSOLDT's public record says it acquired SAIL LABS in 2021 as a provider of AI-based OSINT, processing public text, image, video, and audio sources across 30 languages.<sup>68</sup> It is therefore placed on this front's cut line, not Fusion's. The parent is referenced at the disclosed business-line or segment level only; no total-parent economics are used to imply the size of HENSOLDT Analytics.

A note on what is deliberately *not* graded: **Voyager Labs** is adjacent to this front but sits in the locked never-graded set and appears only as descriptive market-force commentary in the Plays section — no grade, no pattern claim, no distress label. The same discipline governs any NSO/Candiru/Intellexa/Ability-class mention: never graded here, descriptive only, and any negative anchored to a named outlet or dropped.

## 5.4 Their Plays

Five strategic moves are in motion across the OSINT / WEBINT front in 2026. Each is anchored to a dated public event, names its participants, and carries a falsifiable read grounded on a publicly observable proxy — an acquisition close, an earnings or funding disclosure, a public procurement record, or a named product-line launch. Two of the five are consolidation plays, one is a front-wide positioning convergence, and two are growth bets on new buying centers. The surveillance-vendor cohort appears in this section only as descriptive market-force commentary; it is never graded.

### Play 1: The Category Leader Is Absorbed Into a Payments Network

- **Observation.** Mastercard agreed to acquire Recorded Future for \$2.65B, with Insight Partners as the selling owner <sup>7071</sup>. The deal release described Recorded Future as a company serving “the governments of 45 countries and over 50% of the Fortune 100” <sup>69</sup>, and the transaction was announced 12 September 2024 and finalized 20 December 2024. This is the largest single ownership event on the front: the OSINT/threat-intelligence category’s biggest pure-play is now a subsidiary of a payments network, folded toward identity, fraud, and real-time decisioning.
- **Participants.** Mastercard (NYSE: MA), Recorded Future, Insight Partners (seller).
- **My read.** I read this as the leading edge of OSINT being absorbed into adjacent platform companies rather than persisting as a standalone software category. Threat intelligence has become strategic enough that a non-defense platform buys the category leader outright — and the buyer’s logic is data adjacency (fraud, identity, transaction risk), not the government-intelligence mission that built Recorded Future’s roster.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If H2 2026 brings a second large OSINT or cyber-threat-intelligence pure-play acquired by a non-defense platform — payments, cloud, or identity — the absorption thesis strengthens into a pattern. The read flips if instead Recorded Future’s named public-sector references visibly contract after the close, with government customers dropping from its published roster: the integration is straining the government franchise rather than extending it.*
- **Evidence.** Mastercard acquisition release, 12 Sep 2024 <sup>69</sup>; Mastercard close announcement, 20 Dec 2024 <sup>71</sup>.

### Play 2: “Agentic AI” Repositioning Sweeps the Entire Front

- **Observation.** Across the graded set, vendors are simultaneously reframing from “search and alert” to “agents that act.” Dataminr launched “Dataminr for Cyber Defense,” a suite it describes as “built with agentic and predictive AI at its core,” in March 2026 <sup>72</sup>. Babel Street’s 2026 homepage leads with “Agentic Risk Intelligence” and “Governed AI agents on rights-cleared, mission-grade data” <sup>73</sup>. Strider

markets “One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence”<sup>74</sup>. Cognyte’s NEXYTE platform page cites “agentic decision flows”<sup>75</sup>. Maltego and Flashpoint, by contrast, add AI as bolt-on summarization rather than rearchitecting around it<sup>7677</sup>.

- **Participants.** Dataminr, Babel Street, Strider, Cognyte leading the reframe; Maltego and Flashpoint adding AI as an analyst force-multiplier.
- **My read.** I read this as a positioning convergence, not yet a verified capability gap. Every contender is racing to attach the “agentic” label to its homepage. But whether the underlying architecture is genuinely LLM-native or a generative-AI layer over an existing graph or data foundation cannot be verified from outside. The claims are marketing surface, and treating them as architecture would be an error. This is the falsifiable form of the report’s cross-front “AI-native disruption” pillar: name the public claimants, frame each as “positions itself as,” and let a public proof point decide it.
- **Falsifiable read.** *The test through H2 2026 is whether any of these vendors publishes a named-reference customer attributing a decision or operational outcome to autonomous agentic action – as distinct from analyst-assisted workflow. If that proof point lands for one vendor and not the others, the AI-native claims begin to separate into a real differentiator. If “agentic” remains category-wide marketing language with no named-outcome reference behind it, it is a label the whole front shares, not a moat any single vendor holds – and the pillar demotes to a watchlist item.*
- **Evidence.** Dataminr “Cyber Defense” launch, Mar 2026<sup>72</sup>; Babel Street homepage<sup>73</sup>; Strider homepage<sup>74</sup>; Cognyte NEXYTE page<sup>75</sup>.

### Play 3: Private Equity Rolls Up the LEA Web-Intelligence Suite

- **Observation.** Private equity is assembling law-enforcement-facing investigative-OSINT suites out of fragmented point products. PenLink announced the Cobwebs acquisition in July 2023; **Estimate:** approximately USD 200M as reported by CTech, with transaction terms undisclosed, both held under Spire Capital<sup>7879</sup>. PenLink’s Tangles product was subsequently signed by the Texas Department of Public Safety on a five-year contract worth approximately \$5.3M in June 2025<sup>80</sup>. In parallel, ZeroFox was taken private by Haveli Investments at an enterprise value near \$350M, a deal that closed 13 May 2024<sup>81</sup>.
- **Participants.** Spire Capital, Haveli Investments, the rolled-up vendors (PenLink/Cobwebs, ZeroFox), and US state and federal law-enforcement buyers.
- **My read.** I read this as PE betting on two things. First, that fragmented LEA-OSINT tooling consolidates into platform suites, combining web-intelligence collection with location and forensic analysis under one owner. Second, that public procurement keeps funding the category even as privacy scrutiny intensifies around location-data sourcing. The Texas DPS contract is the public proof that the demand curve is still live despite that scrutiny.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If H2 2026 brings another PE-backed acquisition combining a web-intelligence collector with a location or forensics product, the roll-up thesis holds. The thesis faces a public-policy headwind if instead new state-level procurement restrictions on location-data tools appear in the public record, following the documented Texas/PenLink scrutiny – a headwind the roll-up’s economics did not price in.*

- **Evidence.** PenLink/Cobwebs acquisition, 2023<sup>78/79</sup>; Texas DPS Tangles contract, Jun 2025<sup>80</sup>; Haveli/ZeroFox close, May 2024<sup>81</sup>.

#### Play 4: Government-Mission Pure-Plays Grow Through Partnership Stacks

- **Observation.** The government-mission OSINT specialists are reaching a fuller collect-to-evidence workflow through partnership rather than acquisition. Tranquility AI and Fivecast announced a partnership “to Accelerate Open-Source Intelligence Analysis for Government and Law Enforcement” in March 2026, combining Fivecast’s large-scale collection with Tranquility’s evidence-analysis platforms<sup>82</sup>. Fivecast’s 2026 posture is heavily event-led, with a documented presence at SOF Week 2026 and the OSINT Tech Expo<sup>83</sup>.
- **Participants.** Fivecast, Tranquility AI, and government / law-enforcement buyers.
- **My read.** I read this as the specialists deliberately choosing partnership over M&A to assemble the full workflow. It is a lighter-weight path to a collect-to-evidence stack than the capital-intensive roll-ups of Play 3, and one that keeps the specialist independent rather than absorbed. It is the mirror image of the consolidation trade: build the workflow by alliance, not by balance sheet.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If H2 2026 brings a second comparable collection-plus-analysis partnership, or a named government reference win attributed to the Fivecast–Tranquility stack, the partnership-stack model is working as an independent growth path. If instead these stacks get acquired into a generalist’s portfolio, it confirms that the consolidation pull of Plays 1 and 3 is stronger than the case for independent specialist growth.*
- **Evidence.** Tranquility AI–Fivecast partnership, BusinessWire, 17 Mar 2026<sup>82</sup>; Fivecast SOF Week / OSINT Tech Expo presence, 2026<sup>83</sup>.

#### Play 5: A Nation-State / Strategic-Intelligence Wedge Draws Net-New Budget

- **Observation.** A vertical the generalists do not own – corporate strategic and supply-chain counterintelligence against nation-state risk – is attracting its own capital. Strider Technologies raised a \$55M Series C led by Pelion Venture Partners in September 2024, its largest round to date and roughly \$117M in total funding<sup>84</sup>. Its positioning is “unparalleled insights into state-sponsored threats” and a “Zero-touch architecture requiring no internal client data”<sup>74</sup>. Babel Street, meanwhile, has built out a federal-and-threat leadership stack through 2025, including appointing John Larson (ex-Booz Allen) as President and Chief AI Officer in December 2025<sup>85</sup>.
- **Participants.** Strider, Babel Street, and Fortune-100 / critical-infrastructure buyers.
- **My read.** I read this as a genuinely new buying center – corporate strategic, supply-chain, and IP-protection counterintelligence – splitting off from the established cyber-CTI and LEA-investigation centers, rather than a repackaging of generic threat intelligence. The funded specialist (Strider) and the incumbent building toward the same wedge (Babel Street) are both betting that “strategic intelligence” becomes a line item of its own.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If through H2 2026 a generalist – Recorded Future under Mastercard, or Dataminr – publicly launches a named “nation-state” or “supply-chain risk” product line, it validates the wedge as a category the incumbents must answer. If instead Strider’s next disclosed funding round stalls,*

*or it pivots its public messaging back toward generic threat intelligence, the wedge was narrower than the raise implied.*

- **Evidence.** Strider Series C, Sep 2024<sup>84</sup>; Strider homepage positioning<sup>74</sup>; Babel Street leadership build, Dec 2025<sup>85</sup>.

### Market-force commentary: the surveillance-vendor shadow (not graded)

Voyager Labs sits adjacent to this front as a social-media-analysis and web-intelligence vendor that has been the subject of public litigation regarding social-media data collection. It is named here as descriptive market-force context only – no grade, no pattern claim, and no distress, decline, or sanctions characterization. Any such statement would require a named-outlet anchor that is out of scope for a non-graded vendor. Its relevance to the OSINT/WEBINT front is as a marker of the litigation-and-platform-policy risk surface that shadows the social-media-intelligence sub-segment as a whole – the same headwind that Play 3’s public-policy conditional turns on. The same discipline applies to any mention of the remote-mobile-exploitation cohort: never graded, descriptive only, and named-outlet-attributed-or-dropped on any negative.

## 5.5 War Chests & Casualties

A snapshot of the capital behind the OSINT / WEBINT front – recent rounds, public valuations, the strategic investors and owners, and any distress signal that meets the evidentiary bar. Every figure traces to a named outlet, a filing, or the vendor’s own dated press release. Where no public figure exists, the table records “not disclosed” rather than reaching for an aggregator estimate. The Distress Signal column is populated only where a same-paragraph public footnote anchors a specific event; absent that, it reads “none observed.” Litigation-sensitive vendors are listed descriptively and never graded.

| Vendor                                                                   | Most Recent Round / Public Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Valuation (if public)                                                                                                                                                    | Strategic Investor or Owner                                                                   | Distress Signal                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Recorded Future</b> (US – threat intelligence / OSINT at scale)       | Acquired by Mastercard; closed 2024-12-20 (announced 2024-09-12) <sup>8687</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | \$2.65B acquisition price <sup>86</sup>                                                                                                                                  | Sold by Insight Partners (owner since 2019) to Mastercard (NYSE: MA) <sup>86</sup>            | None observed – strategic exit at scale, not distress                                                               |
| <b>Dataminr</b> (US – real-time public-signal / event intelligence)      | \$100M convertible financing led by Fortress Investment Group, closed 2025-04-24 <sup>88</sup> ; a separate \$300M financing led by Fortress and NightDragon, completed September 2025 per Dataminr's 2025-10-21 ThreatConnect announcement (instrument and valuation not stated in that release) <sup>100</sup> | \$4.1B (last <i>priced</i> round, Series F, Mar 2021; the 2025 financings are not described as priced equity rounds – no fresh primary mark disclosed) <sup>89 100</sup> | Fortress Investment Group, NightDragon; priors include Valor, Fidelity <sup>88</sup>          | 2023 staff reduction (~20%) reported by named outlet – treated descriptively, not as a casualty label <sup>90</sup> |
| <b>ZeroFox</b> (US – external cybersecurity / digital-risk OSINT)        | Take-private by Haveli Investments; closed 2024-05-13 (~\$350M EV; \$1.14/share) <sup>91</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ~\$350M enterprise value; \$1.14/share, a 45% premium to 90-day VWAP <sup>91</sup>                                                                                       | Haveli Investments (tech-focused PE) <sup>91</sup>                                            | Take-private priced well below SPAC-era levels – treated descriptively                                              |
| <b>Cybersixgill</b> (IL – dark-web cyber threat intelligence)            | Acquired by Bitsight; announced 2024-11-14, closed 2024-12-11 (~\$115M) <sup>929399</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ~\$115M acquisition price (named outlet) <sup>92</sup>                                                                                                                   | Acquired by Bitsight <sup>92</sup>                                                            | None observed – strategic acquisition                                                                               |
| <b>Strider Technologies</b> (US – strategic / nation-state intelligence) | \$55M Series C led by Pelion Venture Partners, 2024-09-12 <sup>94</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Not disclosed (~\$117M total funding, directional)                                                                                                                       | Pelion Venture Partners (lead); AXA Venture Partners, Valor Equity, DataTribe <sup>94</sup>   | None observed                                                                                                       |
| <b>Fivecast</b> (AU – OSINT for defense / Five Eyes)                     | US\$20M (AU\$30M) Series A led by Ten Eleven Ventures, 2023-04 <sup>95</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Not disclosed                                                                                                                                                            | Ten Eleven Ventures (lead); Main Sequence (CSIRO fund), SA Venture Capital Fund <sup>95</sup> | None observed                                                                                                       |

| Vendor                                                                  | Most Recent Round / Public Status                                                                                            | Valuation (if public)                                               | Strategic Investor or Owner                       | Distress Signal |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>PenLink / Cobwebs</b> (US/IL – digital investigation + WEBINT/OSINT) | PenLink announced the Cobwebs acquisition, 2023-07-11; <b>Estimate:</b> ~USD 200M (CTech); terms undisclosed <sup>9697</sup> | <b>Estimate:</b> ~USD 200M (CTech); terms undisclosed <sup>97</sup> | Spire Capital (PE owner of PenLink) <sup>96</sup> | None observed   |

The capital story across 2024–2026 is consolidation, not greenfield. Three of the largest pure-play names exited to acquirers inside an eighteen-month window: Recorded Future to Mastercard at \$2.65B (closed December 2024)<sup>87</sup>, Cybersixgill to Bitsight at roughly \$115M<sup>92</sup>, and ZeroFox to PE at a ~\$350M take-private<sup>91</sup>. Dataminr extended the roll-up by acquiring ThreatConnect for about \$290M – announced October 2025, closed 2025-11-25<sup>98</sup>. Capital concentrates around two poles: strategic and government-aligned money on one side (the Five-Eyes-facing Fivecast and Strider raises<sup>9495</sup>) and private-equity control on the other (Insight, Haveli, Spire, and the Fortress-backed Dataminr convertible<sup>88</sup>). The standalone-public path has effectively closed for this cohort – ZeroFox de-listed, Recorded Future absorbed into a payments network – and no fresh primary mega-round on a pure-play OSINT collector surfaced in named-outlet reporting in the window. Babel Street is not evidence of an independent acquirer in this lineage: named-outlet and co-investor reporting identify Veritas backing at the time of the January 2024 Vertical Knowledge acquisition. The live Veritas portfolio page does not list Babel Street as of 2026-08-22, so current ownership remains unresolved and no reason is inferred from the non-listing.<sup>49</sup>

*Not investment advice. See Disclosures.*

## 5.6 Winning & Losing

Three patterns govern who is gaining ground and who is ceding it on the OSINT/WEBINT front in 2026. Each is anchored to a specific public event, framed explicitly as opinion, and stated as a falsifiable prediction the next two quarters will confirm or refute. Read them in sequence. The first is the structural fact of the front: the independent brand is being absorbed. The second is the positioning move every survivor is making in response: the agentic pivot. The third is the demand-side dynamic that determines who keeps pricing power once the smoke clears – an accessible, contestable procurement lane with a free floor pressing up from below.

## Pattern Claim 1 – The Strategic-Acquirer Absorption Thesis

**Observation.** In an eighteen-month window the OSINT/WEBINT front lost three of its most prominent independent brands to acquirers, and a fourth agreed to roll up a fifth. Mastercard bought Recorded Future – described in the deal release as “the world’s largest threat intelligence company, with more than 1,900 clients across 75 countries, including the governments of 45 countries”<sup>101</sup> – for \$2.65B, announced 12 Sep 2024 and finalized 20 Dec 2024<sup>102</sup>. Bitsight agreed to acquire dark-web specialist Cybersixgill for ~\$115M (announced 14 Nov 2024)<sup>103</sup>. Haveli Investments took ZeroFox private for ~\$350M enterprise value at \$1.14/share, closed 13 May 2024<sup>104</sup>. PenLink, owned by PE firm Spire Capital, had earlier absorbed Israeli WEBINT vendor Cobwebs Technologies (**Estimate:** ~USD 200M, CTech; terms undisclosed, July 2023)<sup>105</sup>. And Dataminr – itself last priced at \$4.1B in 2021 and recapitalized in 2025 via a \$100M Fortress convertible in April and a \$300M financing led by Fortress and NightDragon in September, rather than a fresh equity mark<sup>106 128</sup> – announced intent to acquire ThreatConnect for \$290M on 21 Oct 2025<sup>107</sup>.

**My read.** I read this as the closing of the independent-OSINT-brand path. The category has become strategic enough that the buyers are no longer other intelligence specialists – they are payments networks (Mastercard), security-ratings platforms (Bitsight), and PE control vehicles (Haveli, Spire) folding collection assets into larger portfolios. The standalone-public route has effectively shut: ZeroFox de-listed, Recorded Future was absorbed into a payments giant, and no fresh standalone primary mega-round on a pure-play collector surfaced in named-outlet reporting across the window. The evidenced surviving independents (Flashpoint, Fivecast, Strider) are now either acquisition candidates or vertical specialists narrow enough to be uninteresting to a generalist acquirer – which is its own kind of moat. Babel Street is excluded from that enumeration because named-outlet and co-investor reporting identify it as Veritas-backed at the time of the January 2024 Vertical Knowledge acquisition; current ownership remains unresolved.<sup>49</sup>

**Conditional prediction.** *The absorption thesis hardens into the defining structure of the front under one of two triggers: H2 2026 brings a second large OSINT/CTI pure-play acquired by a non-defense platform company (payments, cloud, identity, or ratings), or a further roll-up is announced following the now-closed Dataminr/ThreatConnect deal. Remaining independents should then increasingly be read as acquisition candidates rather than durable standalones. The pull is weaker than the deal flow implied – and independent growth is still financeable – under two inverse signals. Either a pure-play collector raises a fresh, named-lead primary equity mega-round at an up valuation, or Recorded Future’s government-sector roster visibly contracts post-close, with a loss of named public-sector references signaling integration strain.*

**Sources.** <sup>101 102 103 104 105 106 107 128</sup>

## Pattern Claim 2 – The Agentic Repositioning

**Observation.** Across 2025–2026 the front’s contenders converged on near-identical “agentic AI” homepage language. Dataminr launched “Dataminr for Cyber Defense,” a suite “built with agentic and predictive AI at its core” (Mar 2026)<sup>108</sup>, and took a \$100M Fortress financing explicitly “to accelerate gen AI and agentic AI product innovation” (Apr 2025)<sup>106</sup>. Babel Street’s 2026 homepage leads with “Agentic Risk Intelligence” and “Governed AI agents on rights-cleared,

mission-grade data to produce decision-ready intelligence in minutes, not days"<sup>109</sup>. Strider markets "One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence"<sup>110</sup>. Cognyte's NEXYTE platform markets "co-pilots" and "agentic decision flows"<sup>111</sup>. Maltego and Flashpoint, by contrast, add AI as bolt-on summarization on an existing engine<sup>112113</sup>.

**My read.** I read this strictly as a positioning convergence, not a verified capability gap – a distinction this report's grounding discipline and its security-architecture caution both require, because true internal architecture cannot be verified from outside. What is observably real is the funding earmarked for it (Dataminr's April-2025 round states the purpose verbatim<sup>106</sup>) and the simultaneity of the pivot. When every contender's hero copy carries "agentic" in the same quarter, the word has stopped differentiating and started signaling table-stakes. The genuine question is not who markets agentic AI – they all do – but who can produce a customer willing to attribute an outcome to it.

**Conditional prediction.** *Suppose by Q4 2026 one of these vendors publishes a named-reference customer attributing a specific decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action – as distinct from analyst-assisted search – and the others cannot. In that case the agentic claims begin to separate into a real differentiator, and that vendor earns a durable wedge. If "agentic" instead remains uniform marketing language across all of them with no named-outcome reference win through 2026 – no independent time-to-insight benchmark, no government reference framed around autonomous action – then it is a category-wide label rather than a moat. It then demotes from a central convergence pillar to a watchlist item.*

**Sources.** <sup>106 108 109 110 111 112 113</sup>

### Pattern Claim 3 – The Contestable-Lane-and-Free-Floor Squeeze

**Observation.** Unlike the classified-collection fronts, U.S. government OSINT is bought predominantly through commercial-off-the-shelf subscriptions on established federal vehicles. Babel Street's AI-powered solutions were added to "Carahsoft's GSA Schedule contract," making them available to "Federal, State and Local Government agencies"<sup>114</sup>. Those awards are openly recompeted and litigated: Babel Street and Dataminr fought a GAO bid protest over the DoD PADELS publicly-available-information alerting award (valued at \$24,923,076.93)<sup>115</sup>, while the FBI bought 5,000 Babel Street licenses for "up to \$27M" (2022)<sup>116</sup>. Underneath that accessible lane sits a compressing free floor – Maltego community editions, open-source OSINT toolkits, and general-purpose LLMs now performing ad-hoc collection<sup>117</sup> – alongside the government-share data showing government intelligence agencies as the single largest end-user segment at "38.40%" of 2025 OSINT revenue per one named publisher<sup>118</sup>.

**My read.** I read these two facts as a vise on the middle of the market. Because the procurement lane is genuinely accessible – GSA/Carahsoft subscriptions, recompeted enterprise licenses, publicly-litigated protests – a software/data specialist can enter this front without owning sovereign infrastructure. That is exactly why the front overflows with contenders and why it consolidates so fast. But the same accessibility means the low end is being eaten from below by free tooling and commodity LLMs. The vendors who keep pricing power are the ones who climb up-stack to where the free floor cannot follow: multilingual exploitation at investigative grade, dark/deep-web depth with maintained access, defensible provenance, and accredited

government deployment. The bifurcation is between vendors anchored to a government mission (Fivecast, Strider, the gov-share leaders) and vendors competing on commodity open-web collection – and the second group is structurally squeezed.

**Conditional prediction.** *If H2 2026 public procurement records show continued recompleted, contested OSINT awards on GSA/Carahsoft-class vehicles (new named awards or bid protests), the accessible-lane structure holds and the government-anchored specialists keep their pricing premium. The “government edge is carved out” assumption weakens instead if a major OSINT/WEBINT vendor loses a government contract or draws a regulator order specifically tied to public-data scraping during 2026 – the scenario the front’s contested scraping-law backdrop makes plausible. The squeeze then migrates upward from the commodity tier into the mission tier.*

**Sources.** <sup>114 115 116 117 118</sup>

## Winners, Watch, Losers

### Winners.

- **Recorded Future.** Sold at the top of the cycle. The \$2.65B exit to Mastercard from PE owner Insight Partners <sup>102</sup> is the largest disclosed transaction in the front. It is the cleanest “winning” outcome available to a pure-play: a strategic acquirer paid a payments-network premium for the category’s most-cited brand. The Winners label is opinion-labeled and scoped to the transaction, not to post-close execution, which the conditional in Pattern Claim 1 flags as the open risk.
- **Dataminr.** The lone independent still acting as a consolidator rather than a target: a \$100M Fortress financing (Apr 2025) <sup>106</sup> funding the agentic build, plus its \$290M ThreatConnect acquisition (announced Oct 2025, closed 2025-11-25) <sup>107</sup> extending it from real-time alerting toward the fusion/analytics layer. It has since added a five-year award announced on 2026-08-26 which Dataminr’s release describes as made by the “U.S. Department of War”, covering enterprise real-time alerting from publicly available information through 2031 <sup>127</sup>. I read Dataminr as winning the “independent that buys rather than gets bought” position in 2026. The caveat is that its last priced mark is the 2021 \$4.1B Series F and the 2025 financings (\$100M convertible, April; \$300M led by Fortress and NightDragon, September) are not disclosed as a fresh equity up-round <sup>106 128</sup>.
- **Strider Technologies.** Winning the net-new vertical, not the incumbent fight. A \$55M Series C led by Pelion (Sep 2024, ~\$117M total) <sup>119</sup> funds a nation-state / economic-espionage wedge – “The Frontier of Strategic Intelligence” <sup>110</sup> – that the cyber-CTI generalists do not own. It is winning a budget line, not a market-share war, which is the defensible thing to win when the generalists are consolidating.

### Watch.

- **Babel Street.** An active build-and-hire platform in 2026, with documented historical sponsor backing – “Agentic Risk Intelligence” repositioning <sup>109</sup>, a federal-and-AI leadership stack (John Larson, ex-Booz Allen, as President and Chief AI Officer, Dec 2025) <sup>120</sup>, and a Carahsoft/GSA federal channel <sup>114</sup>. Named-outlet and co-investor reporting identify Veritas backing at the time of the January 2024 Vertical Knowledge acquisition, while current ownership remains unresolved. <sup>121</sup> Watch signal: a current-owner disclosure or a fresh named-lead primary round that establishes whether

the ownership branch has changed; further add-on M&A would test whether the sponsor-backed roll-up continues.

- **Fivecast.** The clearest government-mission OSINT pure-play in the cut – “Government agencies (40+),” “Law enforcement (30+ police departments)”<sup>122</sup> – pursuing a partnership stack rather than M&A to reach a full collect-to-evidence workflow. That is the Tranquility AI collection-plus-evidence partnership, Mar 2026<sup>123</sup>, on a US\$20M Series A base (2023)<sup>124</sup>. Watch signal: a named government reference win from the partnership, or the partnership stack itself getting acquired into a generalist’s portfolio.

## Losers.

No graded contender in this front earns a Losers label in this section. A vendor reaches this line only when a cited public event anchors a vendor-specific decline, per the casualty-evidence discipline. The qualifying events are a layoff specific to the OSINT business, a missed quarter, a down-round, a named executive departure framed as distress, or a customer-churn disclosure. The public events on this front are consolidation and strategic exit, not failure. ZeroFox’s \$1.14/share take-private<sup>104</sup> sits well below its SPAC-era levels but is a PE de-listing, not a documented operational collapse; Dataminr’s reported 2023 staff reduction<sup>125</sup> and Primer’s pre-turnaround leadership change<sup>126</sup> are descriptive context, not casualty labels. Voyager Labs and the NSO/Candiru/Intellexa/Ability cohort are litigation-sensitive and never graded; they appear only as descriptive market-force commentary elsewhere in the chapter, with no decline label asserted here. Quarterly refreshes will populate this line if an OSINT-specific distress signal emerges on the public record.

## 5.7 The Campaign Ahead

Five watchlist items for H2 2026. Each names a public, observable threshold that would trigger re-assessment of a claim above.

1. **A second non-defense-platform acquisition of an OSINT pure-play.** Signal to monitor: M&A announcements naming a payments, cloud, identity, or security-ratings acquirer of a standalone OSINT/CTI collector. Threshold for re-assessment: one such deal announced in H2 2026, or – with the Dataminr/ThreatConnect acquisition already closed (2025-11-25)<sup>107</sup> – a *further* roll-up, or a Dataminr IPO pricing → Pattern Claim 1’s absorption thesis hardens into the front’s defining structure. Inverse threshold: a fresh named-lead primary equity mega-round at an up valuation on a pure-play collector → independent growth is still financeable. Primary source: named-outlet M&A coverage (Reuters, Bloomberg, Calcalist), vendor press releases.
2. **A named-outcome agentic reference win.** Signal: public reference customers attributing a specific decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action, as distinct from analyst-assisted search, from any of Dataminr, Babel Street, Strider, or Cognyte. Threshold: one vendor publishes such a named reference (or an independent time-to-insight benchmark) and the others do not → the agentic claims begin separating into a real differentiator per Pattern Claim 2’s first branch. Inverse: “agentic” stays uniform marketing language across all of them through Q4 2026 with no named-outcome win → demote the AI-native convergence pillar to a watchlist label. Closest approach on the record as at the research cutoff: Dataminr’s 2026-08-26 enterprise award, announced alongside the agentic-

labelled First Alert Advanced, is a named government award. The release itself attributes no specific decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action and offers no independent benchmark, so the threshold above is not met and this claim is unchanged.<sup>130</sup> Primary source: vendor press releases (Dataminr, Babel Street, Strider, Cognyte newsrooms), government reference-win coverage.

3. **A scraping-law action against a government-facing OSINT vendor.** Signal: a regulator order or lost government contract specifically tied to public-data scraping affecting a named OSINT/WEBINT vendor. The backdrop is contested – GDPR’s “public availability is not a sufficient lawful basis” line and the FTC’s national-security-carved-out location-broker orders<sup>129</sup>. Threshold: one such named action in 2026 → the “government edge is carved out” read in Pattern Claim 3 weakens and the squeeze migrates from the commodity tier into the mission tier. Inverse: scraping-law enforcement stays confined to consumer-facing brokers (e.g., the Clearview-class fines<sup>129</sup>) → the carve-out holds. Primary source: regulator press (FTC, EU DPAs), named-outlet legal coverage, Citizen Lab / Amnesty public analysis.
4. **Recorded Future’s government franchise post-close.** Signal: Recorded Future’s named public-sector reference roster and any government-contract activity following the Mastercard close (20 Dec 2024)<sup>102</sup>. Threshold: visible contraction of named public-sector references, or a public-sector contract loss attributable to the acquisition → integration is straining the government franchise (Pattern Claim 1’s inverse branch). Conversely, retained or expanded named government references → the strategic acquirer preserved the franchise. Primary source: Recorded Future / Mastercard newsroom, federal procurement records (USAspending), named-outlet coverage.
5. **A generalist answering the nation-state / supply-chain wedge.** Signal: whether a generalist (Recorded Future/Mastercard, Dataminr) publicly launches a named “nation-state risk” or “supply-chain / vendor risk” product line answering Strider’s strategic-intelligence wedge<sup>110</sup>. A related signal is whether Babel Street’s standing-up of a dedicated threat-and-vendor-risk function<sup>120</sup> expands into a named product. Threshold: a generalist ships a named competing line in H2 2026 → the vertical wedge is validated as a category the incumbents must answer (a winning signal for Strider’s position). Inverse: Strider’s next disclosed round stalls or its messaging reverts to generic threat intel → the wedge was narrower than the raise implied. Primary source: vendor product-launch pages and press releases, funding-round coverage.

---

## References & Footnotes

---

1. ShadowDragon, “What Is OSINT?”, <https://shadowdragon.io/resources/what-is-osint/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
2. Social Links OSINT glossary (WEBINT entry), <https://sociallinks.io/osint-glossary>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
3. Maltego, “Everything About Social Media Intelligence (SOCMINT) and Investigations,” <https://www.maltego.com/blog/everything-about-social-media-intelligence-socmint-and-investigations/>, accessed 2026-06-14; Social Links / osint.industries SOCMINT material, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
4. ShadowDragon, “What Is OSINT?”, source-class enumeration including “leaked data,” <https://shadowdragon.io/resources/what-is-osint/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←

5. Babel Street, company Insights overview material (“across thousands of sources... in over 200 languages with citations and data provenance”; “any publicly available input in hundreds of languages”), <https://www.babelstreet.com/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ← ←
6. dev.to, “LLM-Powered OSINT 2026: Using AI to Automate Open Source Intelligence Gathering,” [https://dev.to/lucky\\_lonerusher/llm-powered-osint-2026-using-ai-to-automate-open-source-intelligence-gathering-15g0](https://dev.to/lucky_lonerusher/llm-powered-osint-2026-using-ai-to-automate-open-source-intelligence-gathering-15g0), accessed 2026-06-14. ←
7. Cybersixgill platform description (automated collection “from dark web forums, marketplaces, and social media platforms”), [cybersixgill.com](https://cybersixgill.com), accessed 2026-06-14. ←
8. Flashpoint Intelligence Platform, AWS Marketplace listing (source-class enumeration: “Dark Web, Malware, Vulnerability, OSINT, Financial, Domain, Identity”), <https://aws.amazon.com/marketplace/pp/prodview-x2ne64fbs7pww>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
9. Fivecast, “The Dark Web — Uncovering Insights” white paper, <https://www.fivecast.com/educational-resources/dark-web-osint-white-paper/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
10. Babel Street, “Agentic AI for Accelerated Insights into Global Security,” <https://www.babelstreet.com/solutions/strategic-threat-intelligence>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
11. Davis Wright Tremaine, “Commerce Publishes Export Controls for Cybersecurity Intrusion and Surveillance Tools,” 2021-11, <https://www.dwt.com/blogs/privacy-security-law-blog/2021/11/commerce-department-cybersecurity-export-controls>, accessed 2026-06-14; Lawfare, “Regulating Commercial Spyware Through Export Controls,” <https://www.lawfaremedia.org/article/regulating-commercial-spyware-through-export-controls>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
12. Bureau of Industry and Security interim final rule, “Information Security Controls: Cybersecurity Items,” Federal Register, 2021-10-21, <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2021/10/21/2021-22774/information-security-controls-cybersecurity-items>, accessed 2026-06-14; Wilson Sonsini analysis, <https://www.wsgr.com/en/insights/intrusion-preclusion-bis-issues-long-awaited-controls-on-cybersecurity-items-creates-new-license-exception.html>, accessed 2026-06-14; Arnold & Porter, “BIS Finalizes Changes to New License Exception,” 2022-06, <https://www.arnoldporter.com/en/perspectives/advisories/2022/06/bis-finalizes-changes-to-new-license-exception>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
13. European Commission Recommendation (EU) 2024/2659, guidelines on Article 5 of Regulation 2021/821; Akin Gump, “Guidelines on the Export of Cyber-surveillance Items Under Article 5 of Regulation 2021/821,” <https://www.akingump.com/en/insights/alerts/guidelines-on-the-export-of-cyber-surveillance-items-under-article-5-of-regulation-2021-821>, accessed 2026-06-14; SIPRI, “Making the most of the EU catch-all control on cyber-surveillance exports,” 2024 (“use of the new catch-all control has been limited to date”), <https://www.sipri.org/commentary/topical-background/2024/making-most-eu-catch-all-control-cyber-surveillance-exports>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
14. Bloomberg Law, “Meta Sues Voyager Labs Over Scraping Data With Fake Accounts,” <https://news.bloomberglaw.com/privacy-and-data-security/meta-sues-voyager-labs-over-scraping-data-with-fake-accounts>, accessed 2026-06-14; CNBC, “Meta sues Voyager Labs over scraping user data,” 2023-01-12, <https://www.cnbc.com/2023/01/12/meta-sues-voyager-labs-over-scraping-user-data.html>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
15. Courthouse News, “Meta can proceed with data-scraping suit against UK surveillance startup,” <https://www.courthousenews.com/meta-can-proceed-with-data-scraping-suit-against-uk-surveillance-startup/>, accessed 2026-06-14; MediaPost, <https://www.mediapost.com/publications/article/396346/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←

16. MediaPost, "Analytics Company Voyager Labs Settles Scraping Battle With Meta," <https://www.mediapost.com/publications/article/401661/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
17. **Estimate:** CTech/Calcalist, Meir Orbach, "Web intelligence startup Cobwebs acquired for \$200 million by private equity firm Spire Capital," published 2023-07-11, <https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sj11008xsfh>, reports an approximate USD 200M price. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/>, whose current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, confirms the acquisition through Spire Capital but discloses no financial terms (both accessed 2026-08-22). Named-outlet estimate plus public primary transaction record; not a disclosed transaction value. ← ←
18. Mordor Intelligence, "Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) Market Size," <https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/open-source-intelligence-market>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ← ← ←
19. The Business Research Company, "Open Source Intelligence Global Market Report," <https://www.thebusinessresearchcompany.com/report/open-source-intelligence-global-market-report>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
20. GlobalData / Global Market Insights, "Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) Market," <https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/open-source-intelligence-osint-market>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ← ← ←
21. Mordor Intelligence via GlobeNewswire, "Threat Intelligence Market USD 18.85 Billion by 2031...", 2026-05-22, <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/05/22/3299924/0/en/threat-intelligence-market-usd-18-85-billion-by-2031-with-strategic-intelligence-segment-accounting-for-33-60-revenue-share-reports-mordor-intelligence.html>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
22. Grand View Research, "Threat Intelligence Market," <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/threat-intelligence-market>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
23. Babel Street, "Transforming Modern Intelligence with Open Source Intelligence (OSINT)," <https://www.babelstreet.com/blog/transforming-modern-intelligence-with-open-source-intelligence-osint>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
24. Dataminr press release, "Dataminr Announces \$475M Financing Round," 2021-03-23, <https://www.dataminr.com/press/dataminr-announces-475m-financing-round/>, accessed 2026-06-14 — figure carried as the 2021 round, not a current mark. ← ←
25. CIA OSINT strategy, publicly released — paraphrased from public reporting of the CIA's stated OSINT direction, not quoted. ←
26. Mastercard press release, "Mastercard invests in continued defense of global digital economy with acquisition of Recorded Future," 2024-09, <https://www.mastercard.com/us/en/news-and-trends/press/2024/september/mastercard-invests-in-continued-defense-of-global-digital-economy-with-acquisition-of-recorded-future.html>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
27. Tracxn/Clay funding records, via PRmeasured, "Measurement April 2025," <https://prmeasured.com/measurement-april-2025/>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ← ←
28. Babel Street, "Agentic AI for Accelerated Insights into Global Security," <https://www.babelstreet.com/solutions/strategic-threat-intelligence>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←

29. Palantir Technologies 10-Q FY2025, <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001321655/000132165525000131/pltr-20250930.htm>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
30. CB Insights / coverage of Fivecast AUD 30M Series A, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
31. GlobeNewswire, "Babel Street AI-Powered Solutions Now Available on Carahsoft GSA Schedule Contract," 2024-10-08, <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/10/08/2959765/0/en/Babel-Street-AI-Powered-Solutions-Now-Available-on-Carahsoft-GSA-Schedule-Contract.html>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
32. FBI-Babel Street award (up to USD 27M, 2022, 5,000 software licenses), reported via GovTribe/USAspending, [https://www.usaspending.gov/award/CONT\\_AWD\\_70US0921C70090075\\_7009\\_-NONE\\_-NONE-/](https://www.usaspending.gov/award/CONT_AWD_70US0921C70090075_7009_-NONE_-NONE-/), accessed 2026-06-14. ←
33. GAO bid-protest decision B-418730.5 / B-418730.6 (DoD PADELS award to Dataminr, USD 24,923,076.93 — this 2024 GAO-protested award is distinct from the separate ~\$259M 2020 Air Force PADELS award to Dataminr), <https://www.gao.gov/products/b-418730.5,b-418730.6>, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ← ←
34. Tracxn, In-Q-Tel profile, <https://tracxn.com/d/venture-capital/inqtel/>, accessed 2026-06-14; Dakota, "Top 10 IQT Portfolio Companies 2025," <https://www.dakota.com/resources/blog/top-10-iqt-portfolio-companies-2025>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
35. Sidley Austin, "Sidley Represents Mastercard in Its US\$2 Billion Acquisition of Recorded Future," 2024-09, <https://www.sidley.com/en/newslanding/newsannouncements/2024/09/sidley-represents-mastercard-in-its-us-2-billion-acquisition-of-recorded-future>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
36. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/> (accessed 2026-08-22), whose current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, confirms the acquisition through Spire Capital and discloses no financial terms. **Estimate:** CTech/Calcalist, Meir Orbach, published 2023-07-11, <https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sj11008xsfh>, reports approximately USD 200M. Public primary acquisition record plus named-outlet estimate. ←
37. Gowling WLG, "Face value: data scraping," 2025, <https://gowlingwlg.com/en/insights-resources/articles/2025/face-value-data-scraping>; ScrapingAPI.ai legal-cases roundup, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
38. FTC, "FTC Finalizes Order Banning Mobilewalla from Selling Sensitive Location Data," 2025-01, <https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2025/01/ftc-finalizes-order-banning-mobilewalla-selling-sensitive-location-data>, accessed 2026-06-14; Citizen Lab analysis of PenLink "Webloc" geolocation and Amnesty International reporting on Palantir/Babel Street surveillance concerns, named-outlet public reporting, accessed 2026-06-14. ← ←
39. Federal Register, "Protecting Americans from Harmful Data Broker Practices (Regulation V); Withdrawal of Proposed Rule," 2025-05-15, <https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/05/15/2025-08644/protecting-americans-from-harmful-data-broker-practices-regulation-v-withdrawal-of-proposed-rule>, accessed 2026-06-14. ←
40. Dataminr, "Dataminr Announces Intent to Acquire ThreatConnect," 2025-10-21: "In September, the company completed a \$300 million financing led by Fortress and NightDragon, was named No. 27 on the Fortune Future 50, and launched Intel Agents for the physical world..." The release states neither the instrument nor a valuation for that financing. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-to-acquire-threatconnect/> (accessed 2026-09-11). This is a separate event from the April-2025 \$100M Fortress convertible at <sup>27</sup>; the two are not summed, and neither is reported as a priced primary equity round. ← ←

41. Dataminr, "Dataminr Launches First Alert Advanced, Awarded U.S. Department of War Contract," 2026-08-26: "Dataminr also announced that today it was awarded a 5-year, \$318 million contract by the U.S. Department of War (DOW), for situational awareness, force protection, and indications and warnings on global events"; the "\$318 million contract award establishes First Alert as the enterprise provider of real-time alerting from publicly available information for the Department of War until 2031." <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-launches-first-alert-advanced-awarded-dow-contract/> (accessed 2026-09-11). The department name is quoted as the issuer wrote it; the separate 2024 DoD PADELS award in the row above is left as printed at <sup>33</sup> and the two department names are not reconciled here. ←
42. Recorded Future, "Threat Intelligence" product page. <https://www.recordedfuture.com/products/threat-intelligence> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
43. Mastercard / Recorded Future acquisition release (client and country counts). <https://www.recordedfuture.com/newsroom/press-releases/mastercard-to-acquire-recorded-future> (September 2024). ←
44. Cybersecurity industry reporting on Recorded Future pricing band (\$50k-\$100k entry). Slashdot / Gartner Peer Insights aggregation, <https://slashdot.org/software/threat-intelligence/for-recorded-future/> (accessed 2026-06-14). Named-outlet/aggregator pricing signal, not vendor-published. ←
45. Mastercard, "Mastercard Invests in Continued Defense of Global Digital Economy With Acquisition of Recorded Future," \$2.65B, announced 12 September 2024, closed 20 December 2024. <https://www.mastercard.com/us/en/news-and-trends/press/2024/september/mastercard-invests-in-continued-defense-of-global-digital-economy-with-acquisition-of-recorded-future.html> ←
46. Dataminr homepage. <https://www.dataminr.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ← ←
47. Dataminr, "Dataminr Redefines Cyber Defense with AI-Powered Client-Tailored Intelligence," March 2026. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-redefines-cyber-defense/> ←
48. Babel Street homepage ("Agentic Risk Intelligence," "Data Dominance™"). <https://www.babelstreet.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
49. Babel Street backing / current-ownership status. Government Technology, "Gov Tech Biz Quarterly Roundup: Q1 2024 With Jeff Cook," 10 May 2024, identifies Babel Street as a Veritas Capital portfolio company; Pengana Private Equity Trust, March 2024 monthly report, says it co-invested alongside Veritas to support the Vertical Knowledge acquisition by "Babel Street, an existing Veritas portfolio company." Veritas Capital's live portfolio page did not list Babel Street when checked 2026-08-22; no reason is inferred from the non-listing. <https://www.govtech.com/biz/gov-tech-biz-quarterly-roundup-q1-2024-with-jeff-cook> ; <https://pengana.com/wp-content/uploads/Newsletters/PE1/20240331-PE1-Newsletter.pdf> ; <https://www.veritascapital.com/portfolio/> (accessed 2026-08-22). ← ← ← ← ←
50. Babel Street first-party leadership announcements: John W. Larson joined as President and Chief AI Officer, 2025-12-02, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-appoints-ai-industry-leader-john-w-larson-as-president-and-chief-ai-officer-to>; Arun Sankaran joined as Executive Vice President, Threat and Vendor Risk Solutions, 2025-07-16, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-appoints-arun-sankaran-executive-vice-president-of-threat-and-vendor-risk-solutions>; Rob Lalumondier joined as Chief Revenue Officer, 2025-11-13, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-appoints-rob-lalumondier-as-chief-revenue-officer>; Maura Burns joined the Board of Advisors, announced 2025-11-25, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/former-cia-chief-operating-officer-maura-burns-joins-babel-street-as-a-strategic-advisor> (all accessed 2026-08-22). First-party appointment records. ←
51. Babel Street acquisition lineage. Dunami IP assets – Babel Street, 8 June 2020, announced it "has acquired all of the intellectual property assets of Dunami" (no separate close date located). Rosette – BasisTech, 28 November 2022, announced Babel Street "will acquire" Rosette; Washington Technology records close date 31 December

2022. Vertical Knowledge – Babel Street, 22 January 2024, announced its acquisition; Washington Technology records close date 22 January 2024. <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2020/06/08/2044949/0/en/Babel-Street-Acquires-Patented-Link-Analysis-Technology.html> ; <https://www.basistech.com/babel-street-to-acquire-rosette-a-leading-provider-of-ai-powered-text-analytics-software/> ; <https://www.washingtontechnology.com/rankings/m-a-round-up/2022/1871/> ; <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-announces-strategic-acquisition-of-vertical-knowledge> ; <https://www.washingtontechnology.com/rankings/m-a-round-up/2024/2129/> (accessed 2026-08-22). ←
52. Flashpoint homepage (“The Best Data for The Best Intelligence”). <https://flashpoint.io/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ← ←
53. Flashpoint, AI Summarization for Search & Investigations in Flashpoint Ignite (2025). <https://flashpoint.io/resources>, accessed 2026-06-14). ←
54. Flashpoint 2026 Global Threat Intelligence Report. <https://flashpoint.io/resources/report/flashpoint-global-threat-intelligence-report-2026/> ←
55. Cognyte corporate homepage (“global leader in investigative analytics software ... Actionable Intelligence for a Safer World™”). <https://www.cognyte.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
56. Cognyte, “AI Powered External Threat Intelligence” (LUMINAR) page (“deep/dark web monitoring,” “national SOCs...”). <https://www.cognyte.com/solutions/external-threat-intelligence/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
57. Cognyte, NEXYTE “Decision Intelligence Platform” page (“co-pilots,” “agentic decision flows”). <https://www.cognyte.com/nexyte/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ←
58. Maltego homepage (“OSINT & Cyber Investigations Platform for High-Stakes Cases,” “From data to intelligence - in minutes”). <https://www.maltego.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ← ←
59. Maltego platform description (graph-analysis standard for OSINT). <https://www.maltego.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
60. Fivecast homepage (“ENGINEERED FOR INTELLIGENCE,” “open-source intelligence platform that cuts through complex digital noise...”). <https://www.fivecast.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ← ←
61. “Tranquility AI and Fivecast Partner to Accelerate Open-Source Intelligence Analysis for Government and Law Enforcement,” BusinessWire, 17 March 2026. <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260317880251/en/Tranquility-AI-and-Fivecast-Partner-to-Accelerate-Open-Source-Intelligence-Analysis-for-Government-and-Law-Enforcement> ←
62. Fivecast, SOF Week 2026 / OSINT Tech Expo 2026 presence. <https://www.fivecast.com/news/sof-week-2026/> ; <https://www.fivecast.com/news/osint-foundation-tech-expo-2026/> ←
63. Strider Technologies homepage (“The Frontier of Strategic Intelligence,” “One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence,” “Zero-touch architecture”). <https://www.striderintel.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ← ←
64. Strider Technologies, “Raises \$55 Million in Series C Funding Led by Pelion Venture Partners,” September 2024 (~\$17M total per Tracxn). <https://www.striderintel.com/newsroom/strider-technologies-raises-55-million-in-series-c-funding-led-by-pelion-venture-partners/> ←
65. Cybersixgill capability description (7M items/day, 1,000+ underground sources). Aggregated vendor/marketplace listings, <https://marketplace.crowdstrike.com/listings/cybersixgill-darkfeed/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ←

66. "Haveli Investments Completes Acquisition of ZeroFox," \$350M take-private, 13 May 2024. <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/05/13/2880447/0/en/Haveli-Investments-Completes-Acquisition-of-ZeroFox.html> ←
67. Social Links homepage ("Industry-leading OSINT solutions," "Law enforcement agencies from 80+ countries rely on Social Links"). <https://sociallinks.io/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ←
68. HENSOLDT, 2021 Annual Report, "Technologies" (HENSOLDT Analytics; acquisition of SAIL LABS as a provider of AI-based open-source-intelligence solutions, processing public text, image, video, and audio material in 30 languages), <https://annualreport2021.hensoldt.net/en/strategy/technologies/> ; HENSOLDT, 2022 Annual Report, "Open Source Intelligence," [https://annualreport2022.hensoldt.net/en/strategic\\_business\\_development/data\\_empowered\\_defense/open\\_source\\_intelligence/](https://annualreport2022.hensoldt.net/en/strategic_business_development/data_empowered_defense/open_source_intelligence/) (accessed 2026-08-22). ←
69. Mastercard, "Mastercard Invests in Continued Defense of Global Digital Economy With Acquisition of Recorded Future," \$2.65B, announced 2024-09-12. <https://www.mastercard.com/us/en/news-and-trends/press/2024/september/mastercard-invests-in-continued-defense-of-global-digital-economy-with-acquisition-of-recorded-future.html> ← ←
70. Recorded Future newsroom, Mastercard acquisition release (client and country counts). <https://www.recordedfuture.com/newsroom/press-releases/mastercard-to-acquire-recorded-future> (Sep 2024). ←
71. Mastercard Newsroom, "Mastercard finalizes acquisition of Recorded Future," 2024-12-20. <https://newsroom.mastercard.com/news/press/2024/december/mastercard-finalizes-acquisition-of-recorded-future/> ← ←
72. Dataminr, "Dataminr Redefines Cyber Defense with AI-Powered Client-Tailored Intelligence," Mar 2026. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-redefines-cyber-defense/> ← ←
73. Babel Street homepage ("Agentic Risk Intelligence," "Governed AI agents on rights-cleared, mission-grade data"), accessed 2026-06-14. <https://www.babelstreet.com/> ← ←
74. Strider Technologies homepage ("unparalleled insights into state-sponsored threats," "One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence," "Zero-touch architecture requiring no internal client data"), accessed 2026-06-14. <https://www.striderintel.com/> ← ← ← ←
75. Cognyte, NEXYTE "Decision Intelligence Platform" page ("agentic decision flows"), accessed 2026-06-14. <https://www.cognyte.com/nexyte/> ← ←
76. Maltego homepage ("AI-powered sentiment analysis" as a bolt-on feature), accessed 2026-06-14. <https://www.maltego.com/> ←
77. Flashpoint, AI Summarization for Search & Investigations within Flashpoint Ignite (2025), accessed 2026-06-14. <https://flashpoint.io/> ←
78. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," party release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/> (accessed 2026-08-22); the current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, conflicting with that body dateline. The release describes the acquisition through Spire Capital and does not disclose financial terms. Public primary transaction record; announcement, not a separately evidenced close date. ← ←

79. **Estimate:** CTech/Calcalist, Meir Orbach, "Web intelligence startup Cobwebs acquired for \$200 million by private equity firm Spire Capital," published 2023-07-11, <https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sj11008xsfh>, reports an approximate USD 200M price. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/>, whose current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, confirms the acquisition through Spire Capital but discloses no financial terms (both accessed 2026-08-22). Named-outlet estimate plus public primary transaction record; not a disclosed transaction value. ← ←
80. Business & Human Rights Resource Centre, "Texas state police expands surveillance with PenLink's controversial technology," on the Texas DPS Tangles five-year ~\$5.3M contract, Jun 2025. <https://www.business-humanrights.org/en/latest-news/texas-state-police-expands-surveillance-with-penlinks-controversial-technology-raising-privacy-concerns/> ← ←
81. GlobeNewswire, "Haveli Investments Completes Acquisition of ZeroFox," ~\$350M take-private, 2024-05-13. <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/05/13/2880447/0/en/Haveli-Investments-Completes-Acquisition-of-ZeroFox.html> ← ←
82. BusinessWire, "Tranquility AI and Fivecast Partner to Accelerate Open-Source Intelligence Analysis for Government and Law Enforcement," 2026-03-17. <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260317880251/en/Tranquility-AI-and-Fivecast-Partner-to-Accelerate-Open-Source-Intelligence-Analysis-for-Government-and-Law-Enforcement> ← ←
83. Fivecast, SOF Week 2026 / OSINT Tech Expo 2026 presence. <https://www.fivecast.com/news/sof-week-2026/> ← ←
84. Strider Technologies, "Strider Technologies Raises \$55 Million in Series C Funding Led by Pelion Venture Partners," 2024-09-12 (~\$117M total per aggregator). <https://www.striderintel.com/newsroom/strider-technologies-raises-55-million-in-series-c-funding-led-by-pelion-venture-partners/> ← ←
85. Babel Street, "Babel Street Appoints AI Industry Leader John W. Larson as President and Chief AI Officer to Power Next-Level Growth," press release dated 2025-12-02, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-appoints-ai-industry-leader-john-w-larson-as-president-and-chief-ai-officer-to> (accessed 2026-08-22). The company says Larson joined as President and Chief AI Officer after serving as Executive Vice President and Head of Artificial Intelligence at Booz Allen Hamilton. First-party appointment record. ← ←
86. Mastercard, "Mastercard Invests in Continued Defense of Global Digital Economy With Acquisition of Recorded Future," announced 2024-09-12 (\$2.65B, from Insight Partners). <https://www.mastercard.com/us/en/news-and-trends/press/2024/september/mastercard-invests-in-continued-defense-of-global-digital-economy-with-acquisition-of-recorded-future.html> ← ← ←
87. Mastercard Newsroom, "Mastercard finalizes acquisition of Recorded Future," 2024-12-20 (close). <https://newsroom.mastercard.com/news/press/2024/december/mastercard-finalizes-acquisition-of-recorded-future/> ← ←
88. PR Newswire, "Dataminr Announces \$100M Investment from Fortress to Accelerate Gen AI and Agentic AI Product Innovation," 2025-04-24. <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/dataminr-announces-100m-investment-from-fortress-to-accelerate-gen-ai-and-agentic-ai-product-innovation-and-to-expand-its-reach-to-enterprises-governments-worldwide-302437613.html>. Corroborated by Bloomberg, "Fortress Backs Dataminr With \$100 Million Convertible-Bond Deal," 2025-04-24. <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2025-04-24/fortress-backs-dataminr-with-100-million-convertible-bond-deal> ← ← ← ←
89. TechCrunch, "Dataminr raises \$475M on a \$4.1B valuation," 2021-03-23 (last priced round = Series F, \$4.1B). <https://techcrunch.com/2021/03/23/dataminr-raises-475m-on-a-4-1b-valuation-for-real-time-insights-based-on-100k-sources-of-public-data/> ←

90. TechCrunch reporting on Dataminr's 2023 staff reduction (~20%), per GetLatka aggregation. <https://getlatka.com/companies/dataminr> — directional; figure attributed to named-outlet reporting and treated descriptively, not as a casualty label. ←
91. ZeroFox press release, "Haveli Investments Completes Acquisition of ZeroFox," 2024-05-13 (~\$350M EV; \$1.14/share; 45% premium). <https://www.zerofox.com/press-release/haveli-completes-acquisition-of-zerofox/>. Deal terms announced 2024-02-06: <https://www.zerofox.com/press-release/zerofox-acquired-by-haveli/> ← ← ← ←
92. PR Newswire, "Bitsight to Acquire Cyber Threat Intelligence Leader Cybersixgill," 2024-11-14 (~\$115M). <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/bitsight-to-acquire-cyber-threat-intelligence-leader-cybersixgill-to-help-enterprises-to-preempt-cyber-attacks-302305876.html> ← ← ← ←
93. Calcalist / CTech, "Bitsight acquires Cybersixgill in \$115 million deal," 2024-11. <https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sk00u7j7gix> ←
94. PR Newswire, "Strider Technologies Raises \$55 Million in Series C Funding Led by Pelion Venture Partners," 2024-09-12. <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/strider-technologies-raises-55-million-in-series-c-funding-led-by-pelion-venture-partners-302245850.html> ← ← ←
95. PR Newswire, "Fivecast Completes US \$20M (AU\$30m) Series A Raise," 2023-04-10 (led by Ten Eleven Ventures). <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/fivecast-completes-us-20m-au30m-series-a-raise-with-new-us-and-existing-australian-vc-investors-301793523.html> ← ← ←
96. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," party release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/> (accessed 2026-08-22); the current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, conflicting with that body dateline. The release describes the acquisition through Spire Capital and does not disclose financial terms. Public primary transaction record; announcement, not a separately evidenced close date. ← ←
97. **Estimate:** CTech/Calcalist, Meir Orbach, "Web intelligence startup Cobwebs acquired for \$200 million by private equity firm Spire Capital," published 2023-07-11, <https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sj11008xsfh>, reports an approximate USD 200M price. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/>, whose current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, confirms the acquisition through Spire Capital but discloses no financial terms (both accessed 2026-08-22). Named-outlet estimate plus public primary transaction record; not a disclosed transaction value. ← ←
98. Dataminr, "Dataminr Announces Intent to Acquire ThreatConnect," 2025-10-21 (\$290M); transaction closed 2025-11-25. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-to-acquire-threatconnect/> ←
99. Bitsight, "Bitsight Completes Acquisition of Cyber Threat Intelligence Leader, Cybersixgill," 2024-12-11 (successful closing). <https://www.bitsight.com/press-releases/bitsight-completes-acquisition-cyber-threat-intelligence-leader-cybersixgill> ←
100. Dataminr, "Dataminr Announces Intent to Acquire ThreatConnect," 2025-10-21: "In September, the company completed a \$300 million financing led by Fortress and NightDragon..." Instrument and valuation are not stated in that release. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-to-acquire-threatconnect/> (accessed 2026-09-11). Separate from the April-2025 \$100M convertible at <sup>88</sup>; the two financings are recorded as distinct events and are never summed. ← ←

101. Mastercard / Recorded Future acquisition release (client/country counts). <https://www.recordedfuture.com/newsroom/press-releases/mastercard-to-acquire-recorded-future> (Sep 2024). ← ←
102. Mastercard press release, "Mastercard Invests in Continued Defense of Global Digital Economy With Acquisition of Recorded Future," \$2.65B, announced 12 Sep 2024. <https://www.mastercard.com/us/en/news-and-trends/press/2024/september/mastercard-invests-in-continued-defense-of-global-digital-economy-with-acquisition-of-recorded-future.html>. Close confirmed via Mastercard Newsroom, "Mastercard finalizes acquisition of Recorded Future," 2024-12-20. <https://newsroom.mastercard.com/news/press/2024/december/mastercard-finalizes-acquisition-of-recorded-future/> ← ← ← ←
103. Bitsight / PR Newswire, "Bitsight to Acquire Cyber Threat Intelligence Leader Cybersixgill...", 2024-11-14, ~\$115M. <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/bitsight-to-acquire-cyber-threat-intelligence-leader-cybersixgill-to-help-enterprises-to-preempt-cyber-attacks-302305876.html> ← ←
104. ZeroFox press release, "Haveli Investments Completes Acquisition of ZeroFox," 2024-05-13 (~\$350M EV; \$1.14/share; 45% premium to 90-day VWAP, announced 2024-02-06). <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/05/13/2880447/0/en/Haveli-Investments-Completes-Acquisition-of-ZeroFox.html> ← ← ←
105. PenLink, "Cobwebs Technologies Joins PenLink to Expand its Digital Investigative Platform," release body dateline 2023-07-11, <https://www.penlink.com/press-release/pr-cobwebs-technologies-joins-penlink-to-expand-its-digital-investigative-platform/>, whose current page header says **Date Posted: August 23rd, 2024**, confirms the acquisition through Spire Capital; financial terms were not disclosed. **Estimate:** approximately USD 200M as reported by CTech/Calcalist, Meir Orbach, 2023-07-11, <https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sj11008xsfh> (both accessed 2026-08-22). Public primary transaction record plus named-outlet estimate. ← ←
106. Dataminr / PR Newswire, "Dataminr Announces \$100M Investment from Fortress to Accelerate Gen AI and Agentic AI Product Innovation...", 2025-04-24. <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/dataminr-announces-100m-investment-from-fortress-to-accelerate-gen-ai-and-agentic-ai-product-innovation-and-to-expand-its-reach-to-enterprises-governments-worldwide-302437613.html>. Last priced round = Series F, \$4.1B (2021): TechCrunch, "Dataminr raises \$475M on a \$4.1B valuation," 2021-03-23. <https://techcrunch.com/2021/03/23/dataminr-raises-475m-on-a-4-1b-valuation-for-real-time-insights-based-on-100k-sources-of-public-data/> ← ← ← ← ← ← ← ←
107. Dataminr press release, "Dataminr Announces Intent to Acquire ThreatConnect," 2025-10-21 (\$290M); transaction closed 2025-11-25. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-to-acquire-threatconnect/> ← ← ← ←
108. Dataminr, "Dataminr Redefines Cyber Defense with AI-Powered Client-Tailored Intelligence..." ("built with agentic and predictive AI at its core"), Mar 2026. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-redefines-cyber-defense/> ← ←
109. Babel Street homepage ("Agentic Risk Intelligence"; "Governed AI agents on rights-cleared, mission-grade data to produce decision-ready intelligence in minutes, not days"; "Data Dominance™"). <https://www.babelstreet.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ←
110. Strider Technologies homepage ("The Frontier of Strategic Intelligence"; "One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence"; "Zero-touch architecture"). <https://www.striderintel.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ← ←
111. Cognyte, NEXYTE "Decision Intelligence Platform" page ("co-pilots," "agentic decision flows"). <https://www.cognyte.com/nexyte/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←

112. Maltego homepage ("OSINT & Cyber Investigations Platform for High-Stakes Cases"; "AI-powered sentiment analysis" as a bolt-on). <https://www.maltego.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
113. Flashpoint, AI Summarization for Search & Investigations within Flashpoint Ignite (2025). <https://flashpoint.io/resources>, accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
114. GlobeNewswire, "Babel Street AI-Powered Solutions Now Available on Carahsoft GSA Schedule Contract," 2024-10-08 ("Federal, State and Local Government agencies"). <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/10/08/2959765/0/en/Babel-Street-AI-Powered-Solutions-Now-Available-on-Carahsoft-GSA-Schedule-Contract.html> ← ← ←
115. GAO bid-protest decision B-418730.5/.6 (Babel Street vs Dataminr, DoD PADELS – Publicly Available Information alerting enterprise license; award value \$24,923,076.93). <https://www.gao.gov/products/b-418730.5,b-418730.6> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ← ←
116. FBI-Babel Street award, "up to \$27M" (2022), 5,000 software licenses, via USAspending. [https://www.usaspending.gov/award/CONT\\_AWD\\_70US0921C70090075\\_7009\\_-NONE\\_-NONE-/](https://www.usaspending.gov/award/CONT_AWD_70US0921C70090075_7009_-NONE_-NONE-/) (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
117. Free / open OSINT floor – Maltego community editions, open-source OSINT toolkits, and general-purpose LLMs performing ad-hoc OSINT (industry commentary on "LLM-powered OSINT" automating gathering). [https://dev.to/lucky\\_lonerusher/llm-powered-osint-2026-using-ai-to-automate-open-source-intelligence-gathering-15g0](https://dev.to/lucky_lonerusher/llm-powered-osint-2026-using-ai-to-automate-open-source-intelligence-gathering-15g0) (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
118. Mordor Intelligence, "Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) Market Size" – Government Intelligence Agencies = 38.40% of 2025 OSINT revenue (single largest end-user segment); figure carried as a named-publisher share, directional, not averaged. <https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/open-source-intelligence-market> (accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
119. Strider Technologies / PR Newswire, "Strider Technologies Raises \$55 Million in Series C Funding Led by Pelion Venture Partners," 2024-09-12 (~\$117M total per Tracxn). <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/strider-technologies-raises-55-million-in-series-c-funding-led-by-pelion-venture-partners-302245850.html> ←
120. Babel Street, John W. Larson appointment release dated 2025-12-02, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-appoints-ai-industry-leader-john-w-larson-as-president-and-chief-ai-officer-to>; Babel Street, Arun Sankaran appointment release dated 2025-07-16, <https://www.babelstreet.com/about-us/newsroom/babel-street-appoints-arun-sankaran-executive-vice-president-of-threat-and-vendor-risk-solutions> (both accessed 2026-08-22). First-party records supporting Larson as President and Chief AI Officer and Sankaran as Executive Vice President, Threat and Vendor Risk Solutions. ← ←
121. Babel Street backing / current-ownership status. Government Technology, 10 May 2024, identifies Babel Street as a Veritas Capital portfolio company; Pengana Private Equity Trust's March 2024 report says it co-invested alongside Veritas to support the Vertical Knowledge acquisition by "Babel Street, an existing Veritas portfolio company." Veritas Capital's live portfolio page did not list Babel Street when checked 2026-08-22; no reason is inferred from the non-listing. <https://www.govtech.com/biz/gov-tech-biz-quarterly-roundup-q1-2024-with-jeff-cook> ; <https://pengana.com/wp-content/uploads/Newsletters/PE1/20240331-PE1-Newsletter.pdf> ; <https://www.veritascapital.com/portfolio/> (accessed 2026-08-22). ←
122. Fivecast homepage ("Government agencies (40+)," "Law enforcement (30+ police departments)," "ENGINEERED FOR INTELLIGENCE"). <https://www.fivecast.com/> (accessed 2026-06-14). ←
123. "Tranquility AI and Fivecast Partner to Accelerate Open-Source Intelligence Analysis for Government and Law Enforcement," BusinessWire, 17 Mar 2026. <https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260317880251/en/Tranquility-AI-and-Fivecast-Partner-to-Accelerate-Open-Source-Intelligence-Analysis-for-Government-and-Law-Enforcement> ←

124. Fivecast / PR Newswire, "Fivecast Completes US \$20M (AU\$30m) Series A Raise...", 2023-04-10 (led by Ten Eleven Ventures). <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/fivecast-completes-us-20m-au30m-series-a-raise-with-new-us-and-existing-australian-vc-investors-301793523.html> ←
125. Dataminr 2023 staff reduction (~20%), reported by TechCrunch per aggregator summary; carried descriptively, not as a casualty label. <https://getlatka.com/companies/dataminr> (accessed 2026-06-14). ←
126. Primer leadership change (Sean Moriarty as new CEO); turnover context descriptive only, no casualty label. <https://primer.ai/blog/introducing-our-new-ceo-sean-moriarty> (accessed 2026-06-14). ←
127. Dataminr, "Dataminr Launches First Alert Advanced, Awarded U.S. Department of War Contract," 2026-08-26: "awarded a 5-year, \$318 million contract by the U.S. Department of War (DOW), for situational awareness, force protection, and indications and warnings on global events"; the award "establishes First Alert as the enterprise provider of real-time alerting from publicly available information for the Department of War until 2031." <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-launches-first-alert-advanced-awarded-dow-contract/> (accessed 2026-09-11). Issuer release; the department name is carried as the issuer wrote it, in quotation marks, and is not reconciled with the "DoD (PADELS)" award at <sup>115</sup>. ←
128. Dataminr, "Dataminr Announces Intent to Acquire ThreatConnect," 2025-10-21: "In September, the company completed a \$300 million financing led by Fortress and NightDragon..." <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-to-acquire-threatconnect/> (accessed 2026-09-11). The April-2025 \$100M Fortress convertible is at <sup>106</sup>. The two 2025 financings are distinct events, are not summed, and neither is described by its source as a priced equity up-round. ← ← ←
129. Scraping / privacy-law backdrop — Clearview AI facial-image scraping fines (>EUR 91M across 15 jurisdictions by 2025; ~\$51M class-action settlement, final approval 2025-03-20) and EU regulators holding "public availability is not a sufficient lawful basis under GDPR" (Gowling WLG, <https://gowlingwlg.com/en/insights-resources/articles/2025/face-value-data-scraping>, accessed 2026-06-14); FTC finalized orders (Jan 2025) against Mobilewalla / Gravy Analytics / X-Mode-Outlogic barring sale of sensitive location data, exempting national-security and law-enforcement purposes (<https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2025/01/ftc-finalizes-order-banning-mobilewalla-selling-sensitive-location-data>, accessed 2026-06-14). ← ←
130. Dataminr, "Dataminr Launches First Alert Advanced, Awarded U.S. Department of War Contract," 2026-08-26 — the release announces the award and the agentic-labelled product ("Autonomous Real-Time Intelligence for defense and government organizations") but attributes no specific decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action and publishes no independent time-to-insight benchmark. <https://www.dataminr.com/press/announcement/dataminr-launches-first-alert-advanced-awarded-dow-contract/> (accessed 2026-09-11). Recorded as the closest approach in the window; the threshold in this item is unchanged. ←

## Disclosures

---

### DISCLOSURE.

*This is ProductBeacon's independent, impartial market research on the government and national-security intelligence-software market, based solely on publicly available material. No vendor sponsors, no paywalled data, no analyst-firm reuse. The author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte, which competes in fronts covered here; this report reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position, and is not investment, legal, tax, or accounting advice. Full independence and sourcing methodology: [Methodology](#) →.*

### NOT ADVICE.

*This report does not constitute investment, legal, tax, or accounting advice. No claim should be relied upon as the basis for any investment decision. The author holds no trading position in any named public security and is not compensated by any named vendor. Readers who use this report in investment contexts bear sole responsibility for their decisions.*